

The OUD

The king of Arabic instruments



Seifed-Din Shehadeh Abdoun

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Published by:

Arabila Production

1996

Irbid Jordan

Arabila Production

P.O.Box 150272

Irbid, Jordan

Abdoun, Seifed-Din Shehadeh

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Printed and pound by

Arabila Production

FOR ALL
MY FAMILY
WITH
MY
LOVE

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PREFACE

Arabic traditional music is one of the world's major musical systems. It has a long history, and some musicologists believe it is substantially similar to what was performed in the Eastern Mediterranean during the Roman period.

Arabic music is modal and monophonic. The modal system is sometimes based on theoretical octave scales of seventeen, nineteen or twenty-four notes, although the temperament is not generally equal, and the practice is essentially diatonic (the infrachromaticism expressed in *neutral thirds*). The favorite modes (*maqamat*) come from throughout the greater Arab world. Traditional Arabic theory and practice can be seen as a great synthesis of both the earlier traditions as well as regional melodic forms.

The most serious musical expression has historically been solo instrumental improvisations (*taqasim*), although there are related vocal forms (*layali*). Musicians modulate frequently, and indeed a performance that remained in a single mode would not be considered fully artistic in nature. Much of the art is in the way a performer will select and prepare his modulations. There are a wide variety of instruments, although plucked strings are the most visible (including the *Oud*). In addition, there are instrumental and vocal ensembles with a wide regional variation.

The *Oud* is one of the most important instruments in Arabic music; it is the king of all instruments.

Seifed-Din Shehadeh Abdoun
1996

The Oud

The king of Arabic instruments

Term:

Literally, the *Oud* means twig, flexible rod or aromatic stick, and by inference it is “branch of wood”. In Ibn Khaldun (fourteenth century), the *Oud* denoted the plectrum of the lute called *Barbat*. The etymology of the word has occasioned numerous commentaries, among them Henry G. Farmer's alluring thesis that the Arabs adopted the term to differentiate the instrument, with its wooden sound-table, from the similar Persian *Barbat*, whose belly is covered with skin. But this can no longer be defended. The choice of the term the *Oud* depends on a discursive form of Arab thought which required some other word to define the *Barbat* before the *Oud* (the same applies to all the instruments of the emergent Islamic world): in this system of ideas, one term refers back to another or is glossed by yet another, leading to a multiplicity of terms. As the *Sanj* is described



as a *wanj*, the *buq* as a *qarn*, the *duff* as a *tar*, the *Oud* becomes a synonym of the *barbat*. The skin-wood difference was not taken into account. This play of reference is clear as stated by the tenth-century *Andalusian* writer, *Ibn Abed Rabbihi*: the *Oud* is the *barbat*. Other writers, such as *Ibn Sina* and *Ibn Khaldun*, included the *Oud* under the heading of the *barbat* when speaking of its characteristics.

In the tenth century, commentaries on pre-Islamic poetry by *Al-Anbari* (d 916) give the *Oud* two semantic meanings: *barbat* and *mizhar*; *mizhar* was to become a poetic substitute for the *Oud*. Earlier, it could equally denote the lyre, suggesting a process of transference from lyre to lute, the lute gradually acquiring the attributes of previous string instruments and becoming a sublimation of them. This transference is noticeable in the earliest Arabic versions of the Bible, where *kinnor* (lyre) is translated as *Oud* (lute).

History:

The transfer of terms for lyre and lute appears more subtly in the myth of the invention of the *Oud*, which has been handed down in two variants from the ninth and tenth centuries. The myth says that Lamak, a direct descendant of Cain, invented the *Oud*; on the death of Lamak's son, he hung his remains in a tree, and the desiccated skeleton suggested the form of the *Oud* (a contradiction between archaeological research and mythological tradition; the former assumes a process of evolution from lyre to lute, confirmed by organology). The myth attributes the invention of the *mi'zaf* (lyre) to Lamak's daughter. Just as the *Oud* becomes the quintessence of earlier chordophones, it also constitutes their functional synthesis.

In the ninth century, *Miwardi*, the jurist of Baghdad, extolled its use in treating illness, a principle allowed and defended in Arab Spain by the eleventh-century

theologian *Ibn Hazm*. The symbolism lived on until the 19th century: the *Oud* invigorates the body. It places the temperament in equilibrium. It is a remedy... It calms and revives hearts' (*Muhammad Shihab Al-Din*). There is also evidence that it was played on the battlefield. In any case it was predominantly in secular usage that the *Oud* made its mark, as the only kind of accompaniment to a form of responsorial song known as *sawt*, according to written tradition (the *Kitab Al-Aghani* of *Al-Isfahani*; the Songs Book) and oral tradition.

The emergence of the *Oud* on the stage of history is an equally complex matter. Two authors of the end of the fourteenth century (*Abu al-Fida*, and *Abu al-Walid Ibn Shihnah*) place it in the reign of the *Sassanid King Shapur I* (241-72). *Ibn Shihnah* added that the development of the *Oud* was linked to the spread of Manicheism, and its invention to Manes himself, a plausible theory because the disciples of Manes encouraged musical accompaniments to their religious offices. Reaching China, their apostolate left traces of relations between West and East, seen in a short-necked lute similar to the *Oud*. But the movement's center was in southern Iraq, whence the *Oud* was to spread towards the Arabian Peninsula in the 7th century. However, the texts mentioning the introduction to Mecca of the short-necked lute as the *Oud* were all written in the ninth and tenth centuries. The *Oud* spread to the West by way of Andalusia.

Description:

The *Oud* consists of a large sound box connected to a short neck, features that give it its letters patent of nobility and distinguish it from the long-necked lute family (*tanbur*, *saz*, *baglama*, *setar* etc). The body has evolved considerably from the original pear shape (which is perpetuated in our own time by the *qanbus*, taking on a swelling, rounded form). A spherical shape may even have been envisaged: *al-Kindi* (ninth century) described the body of the lute as a ball divided in two, but a century later the *Ikhwan al-Safa* encyclopedia suggested harmonious proportions:

- the length must be one and a half times the width.
- the depth is half the width.
- the neck is one quarter of the length. If the neck measured only twenty cm (its approximate length today), the total length would be eighty cm, with or without the pegbox - an instrument much the same size as very large contemporary models.

Another tradition required the length of the vibrating string from nut to bridge, now about sixty cm, to be equal to the body length, which would leave only fifteen cm for the length of the neck. The soundboard, which has the most important role in governing the quality of the sound and the volume, is made of non-resinous pinewood two mm in thickness.

The body of the Oud is made from lightweight wood. It consists of a series of sixteen to twenty one ribs, mentioned as early as the 10th century by the name of الواح *alwah* (boards) and now called *dulu* (sides). In the nineteenth century, the body was called *qas'a* قَصْعَه (receptacle, bowl), and by the classical authors *jism* جسم (body). It consists of a strongly rounded back (*zahr* صدر) and a flat front surface (*batn*-belly, *sadr*-chest, or *wajh*-face) made of lightweight wood, which must 'reverberate if it is struck' (*Ikhwan al-Safa*).

The sound box of the instrument is pierced by one quite large sound hole in the middle and two small ones on the side; sometimes there are three round or oval sound holes. The holes may be plain or richly ornamented. They are called *shamsiyya* شَمْسِيَه (little sun), *qamarat* قَمَرَات (moons) or '*oyoun* عِيُون (eyes). The bridge, on the lower part of the belly, is known in classical writings as *musht* مَشْط (comb) and as *faras* فَرَس (horse) or *marbat* مَرِبَط (fastening place) today. It bears the strings and stands about 10cm from the lower edge, which is called *kae'b* كَعَب (heel). In a recent innovation by *Munir Bashir* (d 1997), the low string is not on the traditional bridge but on the lower edge of the sound box. The *raqma* (membrane), a piece of fish-skin, leather, or occasionally of shell, between the bridge and the sound hole, protects the belly from the strokes of the *Risha* رِيشَه (the plectrum). This section may take all kinds of extravagant shapes.

The neck, joined to the body, is described as *ong* عَنَق (neck) in classical writings and the *raqaba* عَنَق (neck) or *zend* زَنْد (wrist) today. It extends the upper part of the instrument by some twenty cm and is inserted into the sound box up to the sound hole. This length, which has been much discussed, is important in the instrument's construction, determining the number and location of the intervals and thus affecting the modes. In early nineteenth-century Egypt, *Villoteau* gave the measurement as twenty-two and a half cm; a century later, also in Egypt, *Kamil al-Khula'i* gave it as nineteen and a half cm. In contemporary Egypt, the length of the neck may vary between eighteen and twenty and a half cm. It is standardized as twenty cm in Syria, but a length of twenty-four and a half cm may be found on Moroccan models. There is a nut of ivory or bone, called *anf* أَنْف (nose) or '*ataba* عَتَبَه (threshold), at the upper end of the neck before it bends sharply back to become the peg box. The tuning-pegs are screwed to the peg box; they are called *mafatih* مَفَاتِيح (keys) or more commonly *Malawi* مَلَاوِي (folds, whorls). The vibrating length of the strings ranges from sixty to sixty seven cm, according to the model, but lengths as small as fifty-two cm have been noted.

The material

The quality of material used in the making of the *Oud* is extremely varied; the more the diversity, the better it sounds. This explains the elaborate attention paid to decorative inlay work and the assembling of an impressive number of pieces of

wood. For instance, the Iraqi *Oud* maker *Hanna Hajji al-'Awwad* (1862-1942) used 18,325 pieces to make a single *Oud*.

Classical lexicographers regarded the wood of the *wa's*, which cannot be identified, as best for the material of the *Oud*. All kinds of wood have been used, some chosen for their aromatic quality (like sandalwood). However, there are all kind of which used for building an *Oud*:

- Walnut, larch, beech, cypress, pistachio, oak, mahogany or rosewood for the back.
- Poplar, flame maple or birds eye maple for the neck.
- Cedar and pine for the belly.
- European or American spruce for the top (face).
- Finest ebony fingerboard with smooth fretwork and low action.
- Genuine Mother-of-pearl or abalone fingerboard inlays.
- Hand polished, high gloss finishes.

Some musical instrument used in the Arab world as well as in the Middle East similar to the *Oud* (the Lute family):



Zaz (The *Saz* is the grandfather of the Greek Bouzouki. It originated in Central Asia where Turks lived before their westward migration. Like the guitar in Spain and the bouzouki in Greece, the *Saz* is the most popular stringed instrument in Turkey. Although similar in shape to the Greek Bouzouki, the construction, size and sound of the *Saz* are different. You need a baglama saz to be able to play the microtones (*Perde*) of Arabic music. These instruments have traditional tied frets that are movable, and three courses of strings)



Tar (The *Tar* is the long-necked lute of the Caucasian, played in Azerbaijan, Tadzhikistan, Iran and Armenia. The body is hollowed out of a single piece of wood into a rounded figure-8 shape, with a skin belly, friction

tuning pegs and moveable frets. Metal strings, played with a plectrum. We offer tar in the Uzbek/Azerbaijani style with the additional paran strings, but they could be easily adapted for Iranian playing by removing these side strings).



Sitar (The ancestry of the *Sitar* can be traced to the ancient *tanbur* of pre-Islamic Persia. It is made from thin mulberry wood and its fingerboard has twenty-five or twenty-six adjustable gut frets. *Sitar* is literally translated as "three strings" however, in its present form, it has four strings and it is suspected that sitar initially had only three strings. Because of its delicacy and intimate sonority, the sitar is the preferred instrument of Sufi mystics).



Tanbur

(*Tanbour* is a long necked Turkish stringed instrument, lower pitched than the cumbus, played with a *Risha* plectrum or a bow).



Buzuq: A long-necked fretted string instrument, the buzuq is furnished with two metal strings, which are played with a plectrum. It has two triple courses and a single bass course (C3, G3, C4).



There is a growing tendency to add inlay work to the *Oud*, whose weight may exceed 800 grams.

Four-course *Oud*:

The Arabic *Oud*, in particular, invited cosmological speculation, linking the strings with the humours, the temperature, the elements, the seasons, the cardinal points, the zodiac and the stars. The strings may be tuned bass to treble or treble to bass. Bass to treble tuning is represented by *al-Kindi* (ninth century), who advocated tuning the lowest course (*bamm* or first string) to the lowest singable pitch. Placing the ring finger on a mathematically determined length of this string, one moves on to deduce the pitch of the third open course (*mathna*), then that of the second (*mathlath*) and finally the fourth (*zir*). This system is also applied to the five-course *Oud* and is still used as a tuning method in the Arab world. One then moves on to determine the pitch of the second course (*mathna*), the third (*mathlath*) and finally the fourth (*bamm*). These two schools did not remain entirely separate. But whichever procedure is used, both end up with tuning by successive fourths, each course being tuned a fourth above the lower course preceding it.

Although the four-course *Oud* survives in Morocco, as the Arabic *Oud* (*al Out al Arabi*), the tuning does not conform to the pitches inferred from traditional treatises. The Moroccan method seems to be the product of a previous system, the *Oud ramal*, which also comprised a sequence of fourths: *ramal* (E) *hsin*, (A) *maya* (D) *raghul* (G) This *Oud*, like its Tunisian counterpart, may be variously tuned: a feature of these tunings is that they juxtapose the traditional 4ths with the octave and sometimes the fifth and sixth (D-d-G-c). The strings of *al Oud arabi* are named *thil*, *ramal*, *maya*, *hsin*; this terminology by no means refers to a fixed pitch standard such as academic and standardized tuition methods would wish for.

At the time of *al-Kindi*, two of the courses were made of gut and two of silk. In the tenth century silk became predominant and some texts give the composition of the twisted threads:

Bam: sixty-four threads,
Mathlath: forty-eight,
Mathna: thirty-six,
Zir: twenty-seven.

Another characteristic of the four-course *Oud* is that it is bichordal, having double courses. Thirteenth-century iconography shows that it was already usual to pair the strings at that time, probably to increase sonority but also to allow the development of a more virtuoso type of performance.

Five-course *Oud*:

The addition in Andalusia of a fifth course has been attributed to *Ziryab* (eighth-ninth century), although in theoretical writings it appeared in Iraq with *al-Kindi*. . With *Ziryab* the fifth course, known as *awsat* (intermediary), a term perpetuated in the *Oud* of *San'a'* called *qanbus*, is placed between the second (*mathna*) and

third (*mathlath*) courses. With *al-Kindi* and his successors, it was to reach the end of the instrument and become the string called *hadd* (high) or the second *zir*. According to oral tradition, to obtain an octave on the long-necked lute *baglama*; a low string should be placed in the middle. This is done when the neck has few frets. As the ancient *Oud* did not have a two-octave compass, the appearance of the fifth string corresponded to the demands of a new system. The four-course '*Oud*' had no need to run right through the octave. Its repertoire was performed on a tetrachord or pentachord, transposable an octave higher. With the five-course model, the heptatonic system imposed complete series of octaves. The new lute was called *Oud kamil* (perfect *Oud*).

The five-course *Oud* is the most common and most popular model among performers. It has also been called the *Oud masri* (Egyptian) because of the finely constructed instruments produced by the lute makers of Egypt, who export them as far as *Zanzibar*. The people of North Africa have added the dialectal name of *m'sharqi* or *mashriqi* (of the east). The method of tuning it, extremely flexible in the nineteenth century, is now becoming stabilized.

Tuning, running from low to high: *yaka*–g, *ushayran*–a, *duka* –d, *nawa* –g, and *kardan* - c. However, there are variants reintroducing tuning by 4ths. Thus what is described as 'Aleppo tuning' consists of: *qarar busalik* –e, *ushayran*- a, *duka* – d, *nawa* –g and *kardan* - c.

In addition, two type of the six-course *Oud* could be found in the Arab world: one has six pairs of strings, the other five pairs with an additional low string. The first was found by *Jules Rouanet* in Tunisia towards the end of the nineteenth century. A similar instrument, found in Syria, is tuned c-e-a-d-g-c. The instrument with five double strings and a single low one however, is becoming increasingly usual in Baghdad. Its pitch is at the choice of the player; no rule is laid down. The presence of the extra string endows the instrument with a wider range and increased ease of playing, allowing the performer to run effortlessly through three octaves. The sixth course is also coming to be used as an intermittent drone, a new phenomenon



Oud with six-course

Seven-course *Oud*, based on a complex system of tuning, were found in Egypt in the nineteenth century but have not been seen since 1900. However, you will find some of the *Oud* maker goes far more than that. In the picture, you will see an *Oud* made by *Magrdy El-Ashmawy* from Egypt with eight-course and even with two nicks.

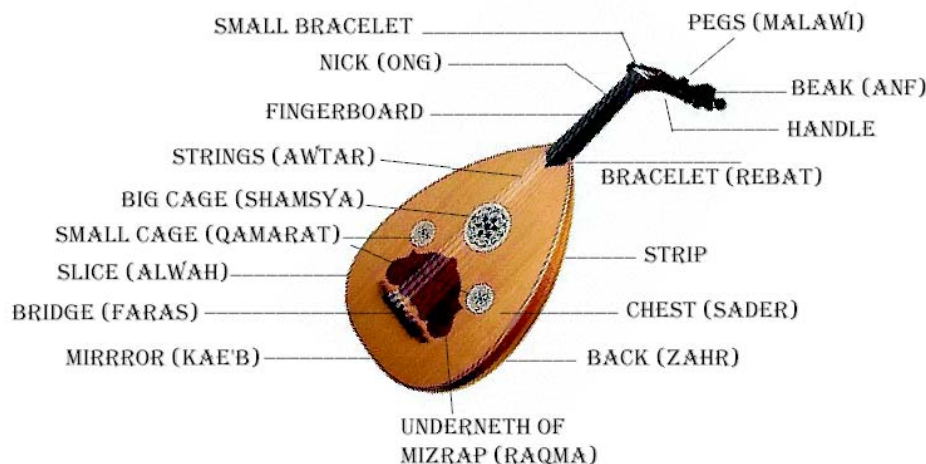


Oud with eight-course and two nicks (Made by Magrady El-Ashmawy-Egypt)

Symbolism of the strings:

Ziryab (Abu al Hasan Ali bin Nafi) was the one who added the fifth string to the *Oud* in Andalusia (*al-Anadalus*). And according to the symbolism of the time, the four strings of the *Oud* were corresponded to the four humors of the human body. The first string was YELLOW and symbolized BILE. The second string was RED for the BLOOD. The third string was WHITE and symbolized for PHLEGM. The fourth string was BLACK and symbolic of MELANCHOLY. *Ziryab* added the fifth string between the second and the third. Its new string was RED and symbolized the SOUL.

The parts of the *Oud*:



Drawing of an Arabic Oud



Strip

Mirror or heel (*kae'b*)

Strings (*awtar*)

Bridge (*faras*- horse or *marbat*-fastening place)



Body (*jism*)

Back (*zahr*)

Slice or boards (*allwah*)



Nick (*onq* or *ragaba*)

Peg or keys (*mafatih* or *Malawi*)

Beak (*anf*-nose)

Bracelet (*taw'q*, *rebat*)

Small bracelet (*taw'q saghir*)

Fingerboard (*zend*-wrist)



Chest (*sader*, or *wajh*-face)

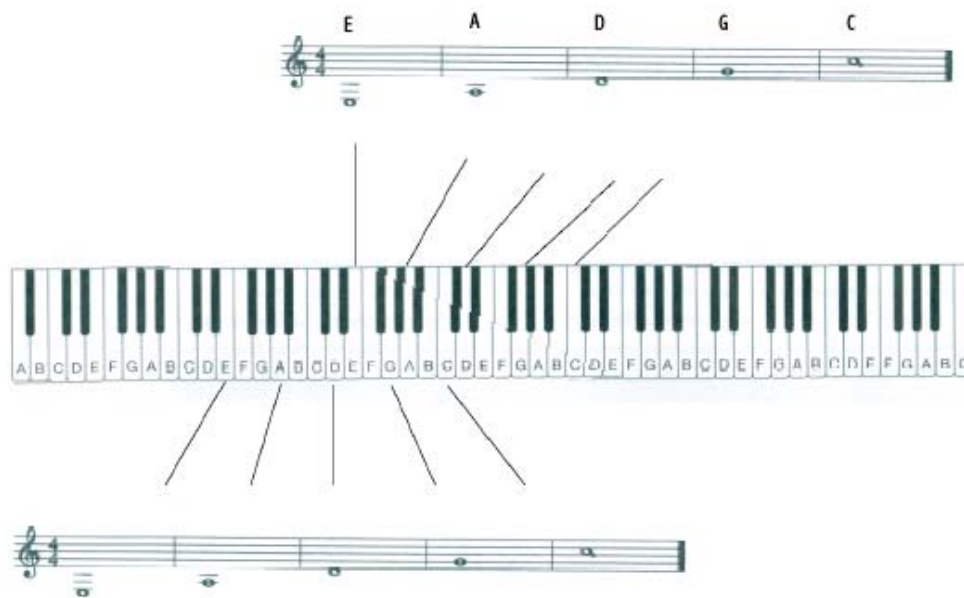
Underneath of mizrap (*raqma*)

Big cage (*shamsiyya*-little sun)

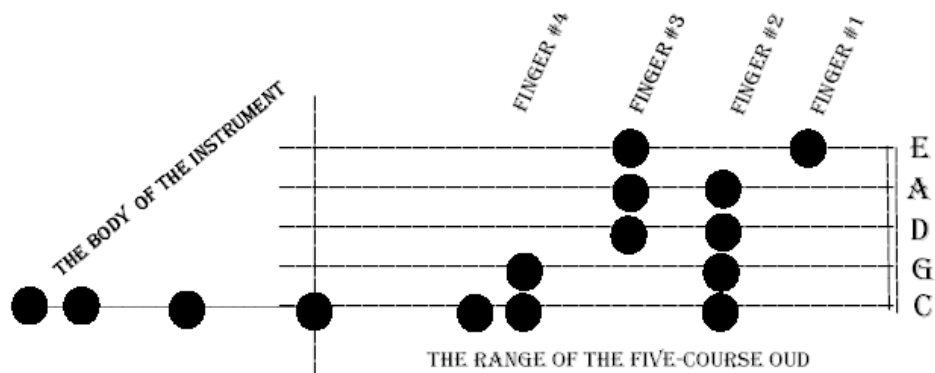
Small cage (*qamarat*, *oyoun*-eyes)

The Notation

The *Oud* music is traditionally written on a single staff, using the vocal tenor clef. In this system, the pitches sound one octave lower than if they were written with a treble clef. Middle C appears as shown below.



The written range of the instrument is also shown below.

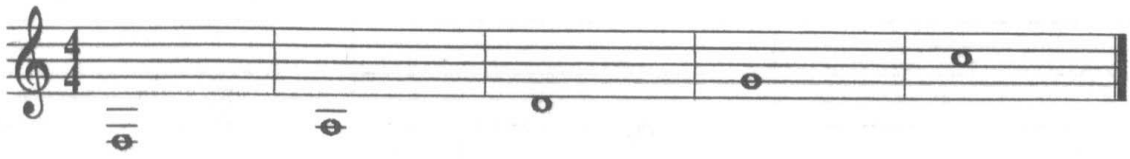


Tuning the *Oud*

The Oud has nine or ten strings in five courses and is tuned C, G, D, A and E (or F). The lowest course is usually a single string, and the rest are doubled. That is:

1. The first (highest) course on the Oud, C in Arabic Kirdan
2. The second course on the Oud, G in Arabic Nawa
3. The third course on the Oud, D in Arabic *Doukah*
4. The fourth course on the Oud, A in Arabic *Ushayran*
5. The fifth course on the Oud, E in Arabic *Poslak* or F (*some Oud players preferred to tune the instrument F instead of E*).

The five open string of the *Oud* will be of the same pitch as the five notes in the illustration of the piano keyboard.

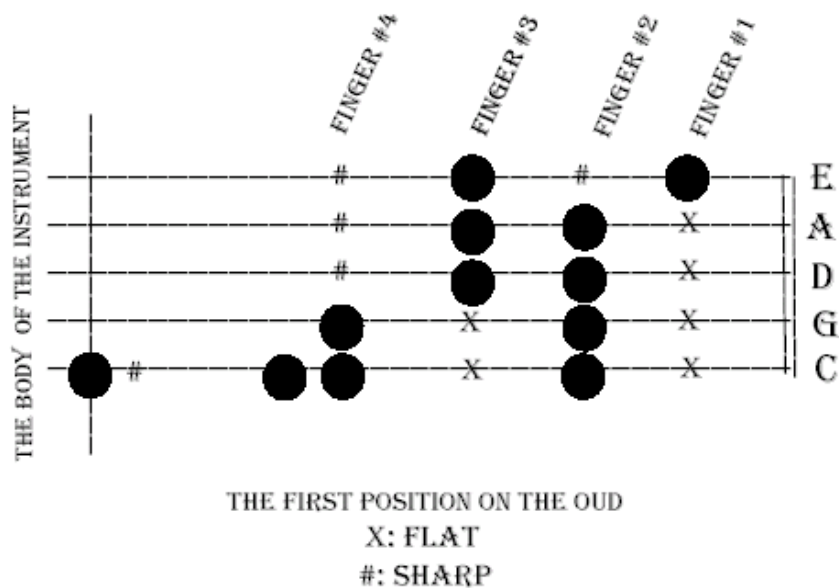


The strings of the *Oud*

The strings (*al-watar*) are pressed down against the flat fingerboard. Since there are no frets as on the guitar and the mandolin, the fingers must be positioned in precisely the right place or the note will be off-key (*nashaz*). The strings extend from the bridge to the head, where they are wound around pegs made of wood like the instruments of the violin family. On a good quality instrument the pegs should turn easily and remain in place after tuning without excessive pressure being required.

There are four pairs of strings (from low: ADGC) and a single string (E or F) that is also the thickest and known as the *bamteli*. The two thinnest pairs (GC) are made of nylon and the others of metal wound with fine silk or nylon thread. When tuned the eleven strings exert a pull of over fifty kilos on the bridge.

The sound range of the *Oud* is comparable to that of the guitar and the cello, but an octave lower. In other words it is a bass instrument. While in wind instruments (Flute for example) the sound lasts as long as the musician blows, and in bowed instruments (Violin or Cello) as long as the bow movement lasts, in plucked instruments the sound continues, gradually diminishing, as long as the vibration of the string lasts. In the *fasil* (vocal and instrumental suite in a single mode) it is the *Oud*, which sets the rhythm with the beats of the *Risha* (plectrum), and comes to the fore in bass areas of the melody.



Holding the *Oud*

The shape of the instrument helps to hold the neck much closer to vertical than you would on a guitar. And as far as I can tell *Ouds*, are not really meant to be played standing. You can do it, but it is awkward and you have to hold it almost up under your chin, in another word it is against your chest instead of your belly to keep it from rotating on you.



Figure 1



Figure 2

The finger board:

On fretted instruments such as the guitar, lute and the mandolin you place your finger slightly behind the fret, not right on the metal (or gut, as the case may be).

The fret stops the string (that is the technical term) in exactly the right place for the pitch you want. On a fretless instrument such as the violin, cello, fretless bass or the *Oud*, your finger stops the string. Therefore, your finger has to be in exactly the right spot. In fact, it has to be in the exact spot where the fret would be if the instrument had frets.

On a fretted instrument, not only can you afford to be a little off in your finger placement, you must miss the fret slightly to avoid muffling the string. On a fretless instrument, if your finger is slightly out of position, you are slightly out of tune (*nashaz*). Now this is nowhere near as hard to get right as it may sound, but it is important to be aware of what you are trying to do, and to listen carefully to your intonation.

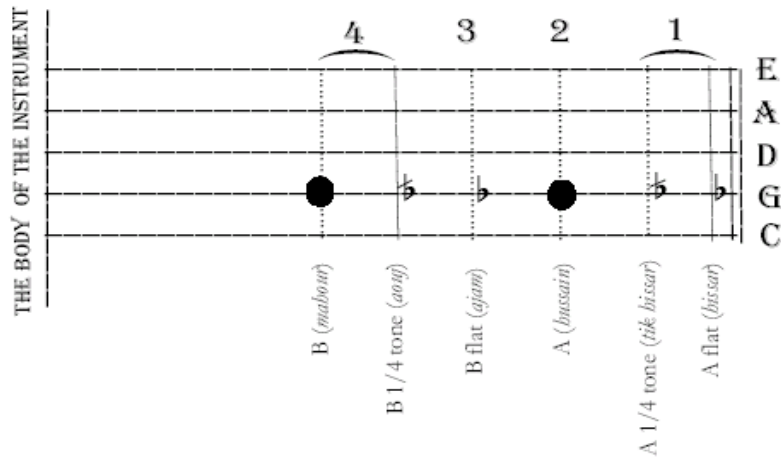


Left-hand position

The traditional classical Arabic method of the left hand is using the all four fingers for stopping the strings of the instrument, one for each semitone. However, you can use the four fingers different from *maqam* to another. I find that the easiest way to finger the *Oud* and to stay on pitch "first position" your home position. That is, the position in which your index finger will naturally fall one whole step up from the nut.

Other than having your hand one fret worth farther up the neck, each fret (half-step) gets a different finger, with the exception of that reaching back for the first fret notes. On the G-string (*Nawa*), for example:

- 1st finger: A flat (*Hissar*) and A quarter-tone (*Tik Hissar*)
- 2nd finger: A (*Hussaini*)
- 3rd finger: B flat (*Ajam*)
- 4th finger: B quarter tone (*Aouj*) and B (*Mahour*)



The *Risha* (*el-risha*):

The right hand of the *Oud* player employs a very special method for holding the *Risha*. The long flexible pick puts the wrist at a specific angle and adds a certain tonal color to the sound.

Oud must be played with a plectrum (*risha*), a flexible flat stick made with a variety of materials and measuring about 100-180 mm long and eight to ten mm width. The tips can be rounded (as in the photo above) or sharpened; it depends mainly upon the player's preference.



Two tip shapes: rounded and sharpened

About the building materials, we have **quill** and **horn** (the two conventional ones) and some new options:

1. Quill: the classical material, originally obtained from eagles. Now that these birds are widely protected by laws, other suitable animals are ostriches, vultures or geese. I tried using goose quills, naturally shed from domestic geese, with acceptable results. Any big quill can be useful. Once processed, it looks and feels like fingernails, since both are made from the same material: keratin.



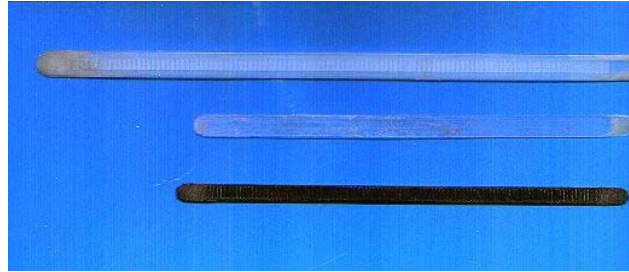
A small size quill plectrum

2. Horn: a very nice material for plectra, but difficult to make. They are my preferred ones, but it is a personal choice. Big horns must be used (not from cows).



Two examples of horn plectra, both with rounded tips

3. Plastic: an easy to handle material, resistant but maybe not the best for playing purposes. Anyway, it is very common to use them. About the proper flexibility, there have been many attempts in order to discover the best suitable plastic.



They are three types of plastic plectra. They have different lengths and flexibilities, depending upon the player's choice

4. Sea tortoise shell: it is a non-conventional material, but helpful: very resistant and natural. The Risha from this material is big and triangular-shaped ones.



The angle at which the plectrum strikes the string and the distance from the bridge both affect the sound to a considerable degree. Traditionally musicians preferred to play to the sound hole, which produced a softer tone, but today many *Oud* players prefer the stronger and crisper sound produced by playing close to the bridge to the *mizrap*.

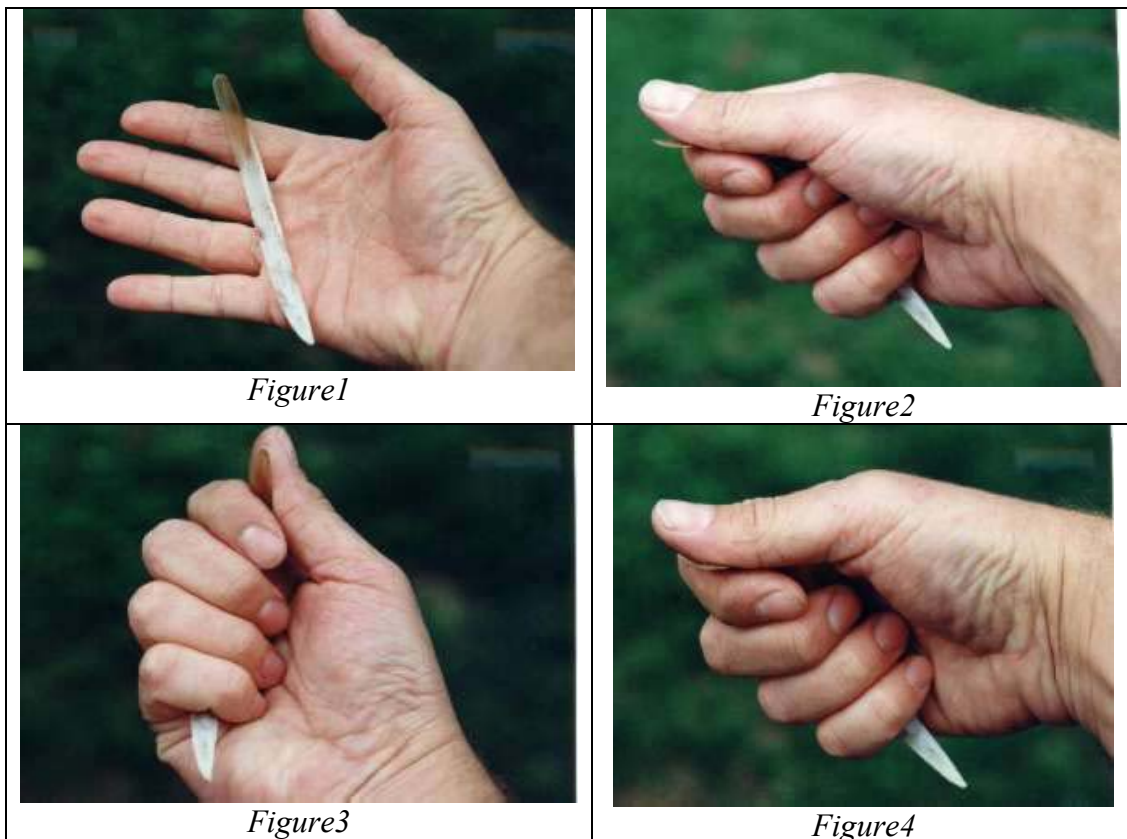
Picking: Flat picks marking are as follows:

▣ = Down Pick
 ▽ = Up Pick

The right hand:

As for the right hand, there's a special (*Risha*) plectrum you are supposed to use, as we described it before it is long and narrow, either made from a quill or made from plastic and shaped to imitate a quill.

You can use either “*alternate picking*” or “*economy picking*”. Alternate picking means that on each stroke you switch between down strokes and upstrokes. Economy picking is similar to alternate picking, except that when you change strings your next stroke is in the same direction your hand just moved.

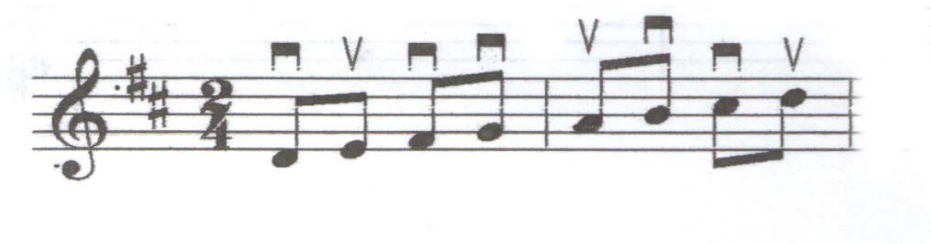


For example; starting a **D major scale** (*has two # sharps*) on the **D string**, using economy picking you would play:

D (3/open, *down stroke*), E (3/index, *up stroke*), F# (3/ring, *down stroke*),
G (2/open, *down stroke*), A (2/index, *up stroke*), B (2/ring, *down stroke*),
C# (1/index, *downstroke*), D (1/index, *upstroke*).

Using strict alternate picking, each down stroke would be followed by an up stroke and vice versa.

Example For down stroke and up stroke:



The proper right-hand stroke is angled towards the body slightly, such that the down stroke catches both strings and the up stroke only one. But implied that there is still a difference in sound between the two.

Note that the strings are played closer to the bridge than they would be on a guitar. You've got something that looks kind of like a pick guard between the largest sound hole and the bridge. If so, that's the area in which you want to pick. This produces the characteristic twangy, percussive sound of the *Oud*. If you play over the sound hole, or even closer to the middle of the string than that, the sound you will get is actually a lot closer to the lute or to the guitar tone.

The *Oud* is not a loud instrument, though more expensive ones do seem to be louder than cheap ones. That twang contains all the high-frequency overtones that will allow your sound to cut through the mix as much as it ever will.

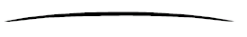
The technical methods of the *Oud*

The slide: The slide is performed by one finger of the left hand sliding over the neck of the *Oud* from the first note to the second note. The first note is struck, and the second note is sounded by the slide. The following sign indicates the slide:



The Slur: In musical notation, a curved line grouping notes together. To execute ascending slurs of two notes for the *Oud*, the lower is played and the finger of the left hand descends hammer-like upon the higher note, creating the tone desired.

Descending slurs are executed by finger fingering the notes to be played with the left hand. Strike the higher note by drawing the finger sideways off the string; the

lower note will automatically sound, and slurred notes are connected by a curved line ().



Ascending Slur



Descending Slur

Hammer-on/pull-off: Ascending slurs are sometimes termed “hammer-ones.” They are written as the following:



Descending slurs are sometimes termed “pull-off.” They are written as the following:



The Tremolo: This sign (=) indicates the tremolo. The tremolo is a rapid succession of alternate down and up strokes.



A tremolo study: whole- notes and half-notes

The Snap: The snap is similar to the slur in execution. The second of the snap is usually an open string. The first note is played, and immediately the left-hand finger pulls the string sideways as it slides off the fingerboard.

When snapping a note to a closed note, both notes should be held before executing the snap effect. And you will use this in the improvisations (*Taqasim*) very much.



The Glissando: The glissando will be designated a wavy line with the abbreviation “Gliss” directly underneath it. Glissando is sliding up and down the scale, or making a quick uninterrupted passage up and down the scale. Also, it is preformed by combining the slide and tremolo.

On the *Oud*, the first note will be tremoloed while sliding to the second.

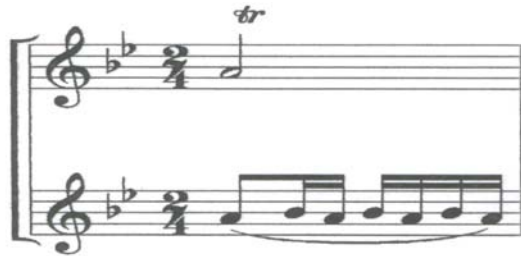


Grace Notes

Grace notes are small notes, which subtract their value from the note they precede. The technical term for the grace note is “appoggiatura.” The grace note is crossed at the end and is played the same as slurs. On the *Oud*, when the grace note is on a different string from the principle note, pick it separately. Grace notes use to decorate the melody. You will note a lot of use to grace notes in Arabic music especially in *el-taqsim*.



The Trill: Trill is a musical ornament designated by (*tr*) over the note. When a note alternates according to its value very rapidly with a tone, half tone or quartertone above it, the effect produced is termed “the trill.” This is best produced by bicking the first or principal note and slurring the upper auxiliary note.



Vibrato: Vibrato is a rapid regular fluctuation in pitch-whatever tasteful. Vibrato is not a tremolo.

el-Sad wel-Rad: In the following figure there are two line; the first line the actual music with out any decorations, and in the second line it written the way the *Oud* player play it. This kind of technique (*el-Sad wel-Rad*) used in the most with the improvisations or the *Taqasim* and as you notes gives the melody a very colorful taste.



The use of the *Oud*

Taqasim: Taqasim is a traditional Arab musical form. It is introduction-in most cases- to the most important musical themes plus a few simple additional improvisations by the *Oud* player.

Improvisation: Improvisation is one of the distinctive features of Arabic music, inherited from-singing traditions such as *al-mowashahat* (the Andalusia Arabic Songs). It is usually does not features the prepared musical themes.

Musical Forms: Piece with composed theme Consisting of highly especially suited expressing these emotions and it could be:

- Solo *Oud* only.
- With group such as: *Samae Thaqiel, Tahmeleh, Longa and Bashraf*.
- Or with the orchestra such as: *fantasia el-Oud and the Orchestra* (1985) by my teacher and friend the Egyptian composer and conductor *Saed Awad* (d 1999).

Other Musical Compositions (influence by Western music): What I mean by that all the musical pieces composed (*in most cases*) by the *Oud* players them selves. However, the kind of music named by the composer such as; *al-Usfour, Angham, Ashwaq*, etc...and of course doesn't have any particular Form or Format like *Samae Tahqiel* or *Longa* as a sample.

Performance and Aesthetics

The strings of the contemporary *Oud* are twisted, or spirally reinforced. They are plucked with a plectrum (*risha*-quill) made of an eagle's feather and held between thumb and index finger; a shell or plastic plectrum may be used instead. The technique calls for suppleness of the wrist as the plectrum strikes the strings in a simple fall, or combines risings and fallings.

There are two conceptions of performance. The first takes as its principle the ornamentation of the sound, produced by delicate glissandos of the fingers and slight vibratos. The touch of the *Risha* on the string sets off a vibration, which in turn, gives rise to an effect of resonance, volume and controlled intensity. The *Risha* does not interfere with the resulting sound. This produces an intimate style of playing, making the interiorized *Oud* a path to meditation, this approach was first promoted in Istanbul by *Ali Rifat Cagatay* (1867-1935), and then was developed in Baghdad by *Salman Shukur* (b 1921), *Jamil Bashir* (1925-77) and *Munir Bashir* (1930-1999).

The second aesthetic approach is Egyptian. The volume is amplified by firm strokes of the *Risha*, which makes the strings resonate; the result is a curiously dulled sound, akin to the nasal effect of Egyptian song. This calls for virtuosity in performance, which is conceived of as an exteriorizing factor. The finest

proponents of this school have been *Sufar Ali* (1884-1962), *Muhammad al-Qassabji* (1898-1966) and the very famous singer, composer and the *Oud* player *Farid al-Atrash* (1907-1975).

The Makers

The Oud makers who manufacture the Oud are founded in almost all Arab worlds, especially in big cities like:

- *Mohamed Fadil Awwad* of Baghdad.
- *Nazih Ghadban* of Beirut.
- *H. Nahhat* of Damascus.

However, in being the best Oud maker in the Arab world, and indeed, because of the excellent sound of their *Oud*.

The Iraqi Oud makers such: *Mohamed Fadel*, *Ali Al-armani*, and *Faozi Minshad* are the best Oud builders in the Arab world and the Meddle East, because of the style of playing this instrument became very advanced because of the great Oud players like *Jameel Basher*, *Muoner Bashir*, *Ganim Hadad*, *Nassir Shamma*, and *Ahmed Mukhtar*.



Figure1



Figure2



Figure3

However, they are some of other good Oud makers in and out side Arab world:

- *Mgdi El-Shamawy*

Born in Egypt in 1942. Obtained 4 universities degrees, one of them in Arabic Music. He was a member of *Dr. Gouhar Saloon*, which included *Riyad El-*

Sombati, Zakaria Ahmad, Ahmad Rami, and most of the contemporary artists “between” 1952 - 1969.

El-Shamawy was emigrated from Egypt to England in 1970. He was the founder of the Plastic Nay in 1986; this instrument can be made according to pure mathematics and can be tuned from 1/2 tone to any fraction of a tone.

El-Shamawy was the first to modify the Arabic Lute for thousands of years by founding the perfect mathematical formula to obtain the most sustained and better sound quality in the Lute.

- *Ibrahim Hamoudeh*:

He was born in Baghdad in 1940 in *Mahall Babelsheikh*. He obtained diploma in Electricity in 1963 and obtained diploma in Accountancy in 1967.



Ibrahim Hamoudeh

Hamoudeh occupied different governmental jobs for 27 years. He was graduated from the musical instrument-making workshop belonging to the Ministry of culture and Media with distinction and worked there as *Oud*-making specialist. He was the student of the most skillful *Oud* maker, *Mohammed bin Osta Ali Alawwad* in Baghdad. He honored him with a special certificate in 1978. *Hamoudeh* established a specialized workshop for making and mending oriental musical instruments, which was called *Alqeethara Workshop*. He obtained the certificate of practising this career from the Ministry of culture and Media.

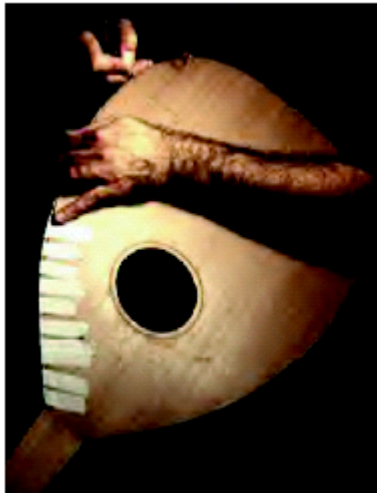
- *Thierry*:

He made apart from conventional electric, acoustic and classical guitars, and *Oud*, and two very unusual 7 strings instrument provided with colored fingerboards. Here are some pictures of these instruments:



Mr. Thierry doing the final cleaning of the finished Oud

- *Najib Shaheen*



- Samir Azar: Lebanon.
- Farouk Shehat: Egypt.
- Mohamed Fadil El-Hussein: Iraq.
- Hanna Hajji al-'Awwad, Iraq.

Some of the *Oud* Paintings in the Arabic/Islamic history



No title



*Ibrahim Mirza's garden party
Anthony and Stuart Cary Welch:
Arts of the Islamic Book*



*The garden of Husayn Baygara
Iran-Persian miniatur*



Kaikaus and the Bard: Islamic miniature



Title unknown



No title: Yalcin Tura(d. 1934, İstanbul): Ask ve Huzun



*Entertainment
Anthony Welch: Artists for the Shah*



Dervishes whirling to musical accompaniment International Journal of Music in Turkey



Pacaci & Aksoy : Music in the court of Suleyman I



Entertainment given in honor of Hulagu by his brother, Monkka Islamic miniature



The Feast of Eid Begins



A personage receiving guests in a garden pavilion



Jawad Selim (1950): Dancer, Watercolor



Oud in Ferdousi's Shahnameh



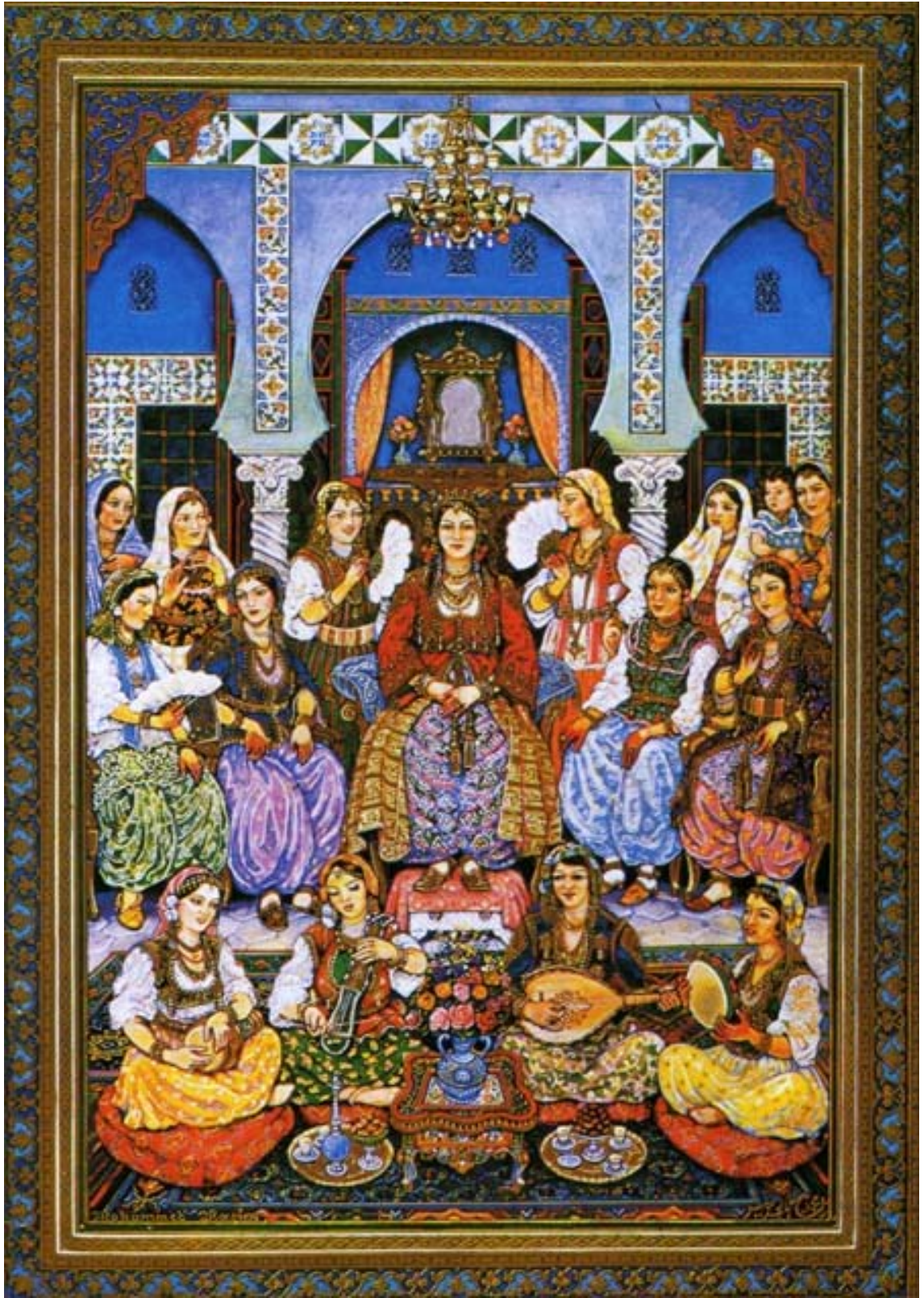
Islamic Miniature



Qud Illustration in Chehel Sotoun, Isfahan



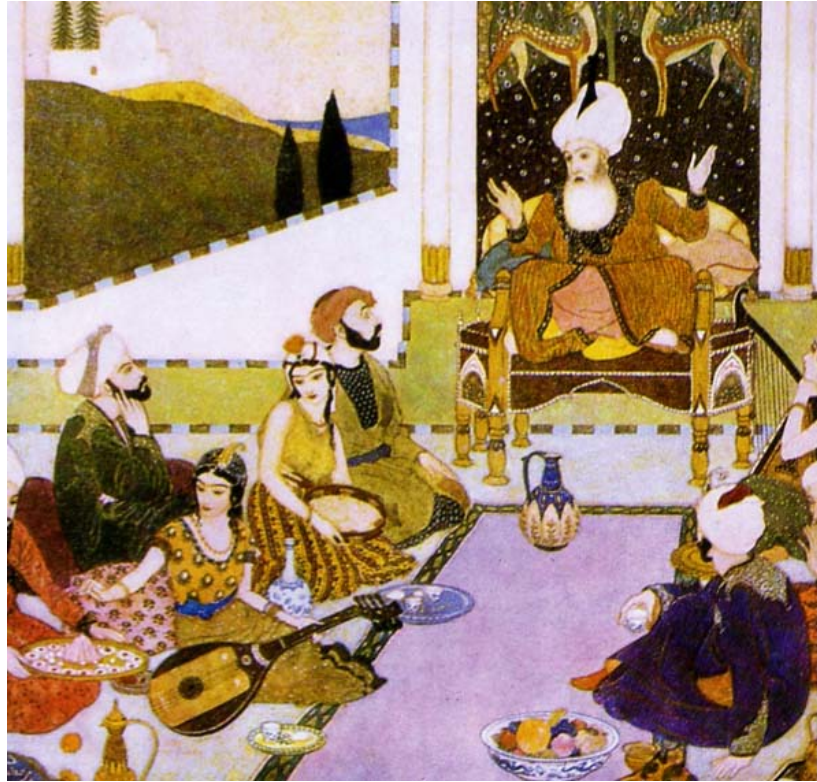
Muhammad Racim (1830): Two Algerian Women Dancing Together



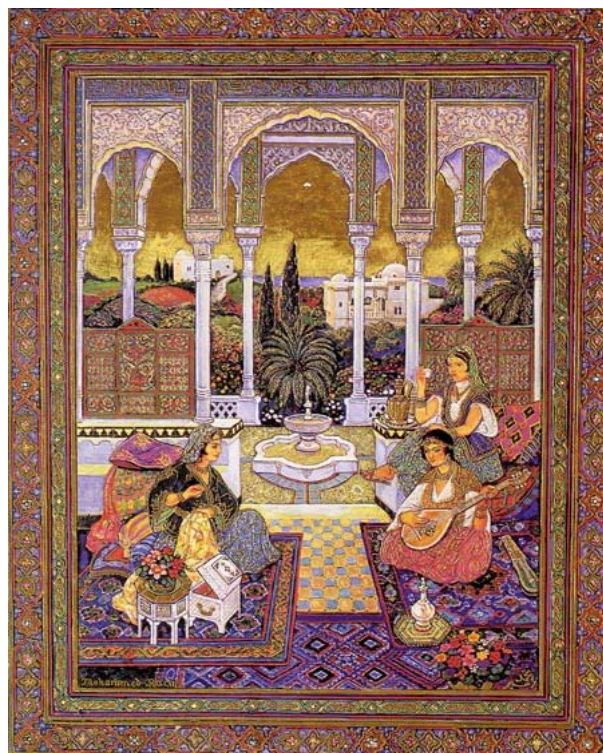
Muhammad Racim (1830): Wedding Celebrations in Algeria



Clement Pujol (19th century): Entertaining the Shaikh



Edmund Dulac: A musical Entertainment, from the "Tale of 1001 Nights"



Muhammad Racim (1832): Evening in Algeria

The *Oud* in Europe:

During the middle Ages, the *Oud* was finding its way toward Europe, with the returning crusaders as well as through Spain in the West and Byzantium in the East. Troubadours, musicians and wandering singers took up the instrument to accompany their singing. Not until the sixteenth century. However, all the European names for the instrument—*laut*, *alaude*, *laud*, *luth*, *liuto*, and the *lute*—can be derived from the Arabic word (*al-Oud*), calling to mind the Golden Age that this essentially Arabian instrument experienced in the west.



*Lute by Giovanni Hieber. Second half of the 16th century.
Conservatoire Royal de Musique, Brussels.*

In Europe, the Lute was a very popular instrument. It became the first accompanying plucked instrument for popular songs.



Orazio Gentileschi (Florentine 1563-1647). Young Woman Playing the Lute



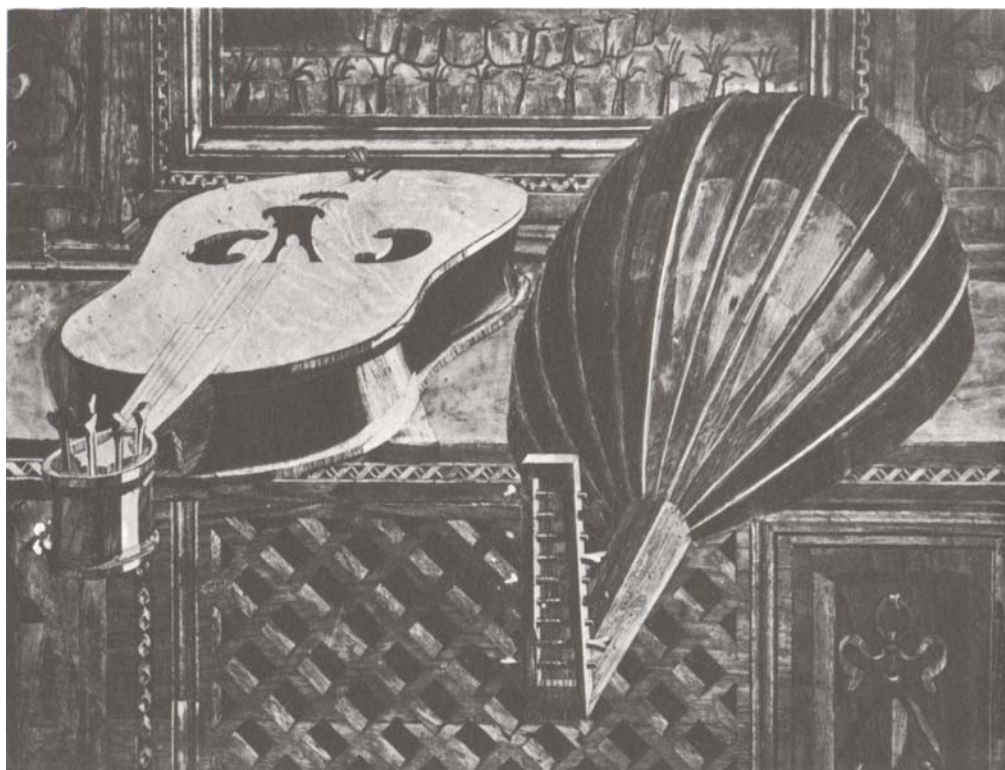
Piero della Francesca (1410-1492): The Nativity, Concert of Angels, 1479



*V. Carpaccio. Angel playing the Lute
Courtesy of the Galleria dell'Academia, Venice*



Oud (Lute) player, title page of Lorenzo de' Medici, Selve d'amore



Leonardo da Vinci: Intarsia of the Oud and lira da braccio.



In this picture you see the Oud (Lute) and the Rabab (Rebec: a high bowed instrument).



*Francia, two angels, the left one playing fiddle and the right one playing Oud
From St. Lawrence and St. Jerome. Hermitage.*



Bartholomeus vander Helst (1662): Musician



Gaudenzio Ferrari, altarpiece. Pinacoteca, Turin



Caravaggi (1573-1610): Allegory of Music, 1595



Carlo Saraceni (1610): St. Cecilia with the Angel



Caravaggio (1573-1610): The Lute Player, 1594



The Prodigal Son in the Tavern (16th century): by someone in the circle of Jan Cornelis



Gaudenzio Ferrari (1475-1546): The Assumption of the Virgin, 1534



Parrasio Micheli (1550): The Lute Playing Venus



Hans Leu The Younger (1490-1531): Orpheus and the Animals, 1519



Sebastian Stockopff (1597-1657): Summer or The Five Senses, 1633



Gabriel Metsu (1629-1667): A Lady Writing Music, 1660-1665



Hendrick Ter Brugghen (1628): Duet



Titian (1490—1576): Le Concert Chametre, 1511



Laurenr de La Hyre (1606-1656): Allefory of Music, 1649



Hans Holbein the Younger (1497-1543): Jean de Dinteville and George de Selve, 1533



A. Bosse (1625): A Lute Playing Nobelman



Vermeer (1650): Girl Playing the Lute



Gerard Ter Borch (1657): The Concert



Angels, 16th century



Hans Memling (1480) from a panel



Excerpted from a picture of a public bathhouse, 1470.



Jean Simeon Charin (1699-1779): The Attributes of Music, 1765



Magnus Duijffoprugcar (1610): Theorbo Lute



Castello Storzasco (18th century): Soprano Lute



Jost Amman woodcut: The Lute Maker, 1568



Lorenzo Costa: The Concert (a lute player accompanying singers)

The following chart is according to al-Farabis' theory and method

AB: Sting Length

AC: $1/9$ AB

AE: $EB = 1/2$ AB

EF: $FB = 1/2$ BE

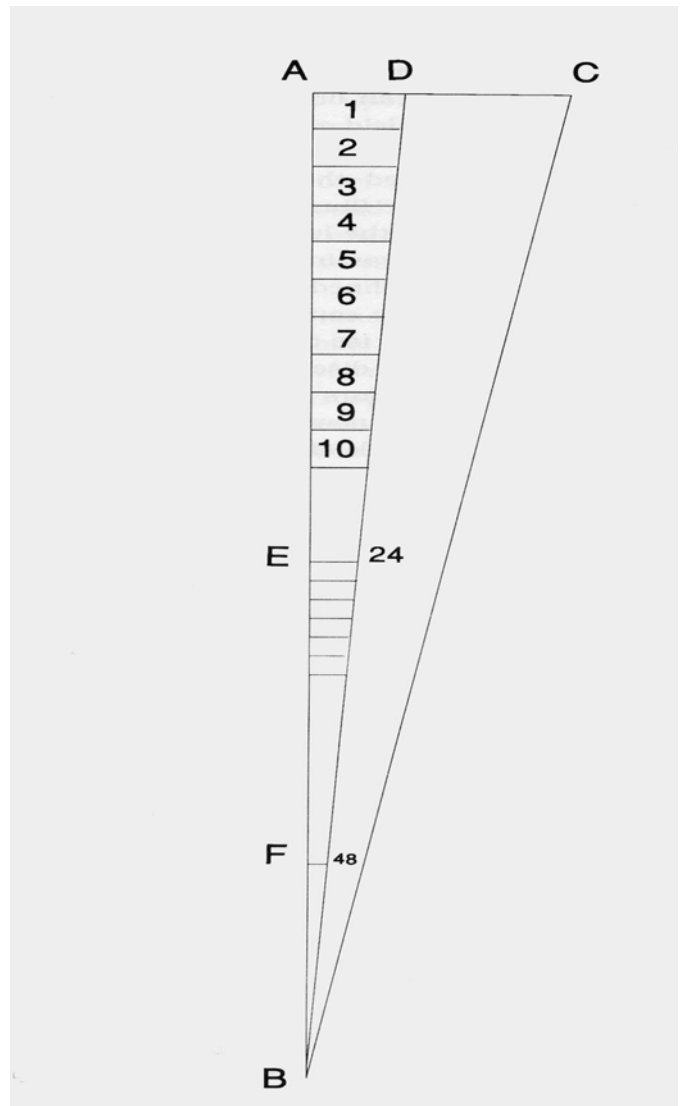
AD: $1/4$ AC = $1/38$ AB

BAC: 90 DEGREES

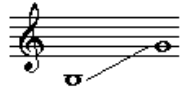
Divide AE into 24 equal parts

Divide EF into 24 equal parts

AD1, AD2, AD3...represent the distance between frets on the neck of the Out



The name of Arabic notes



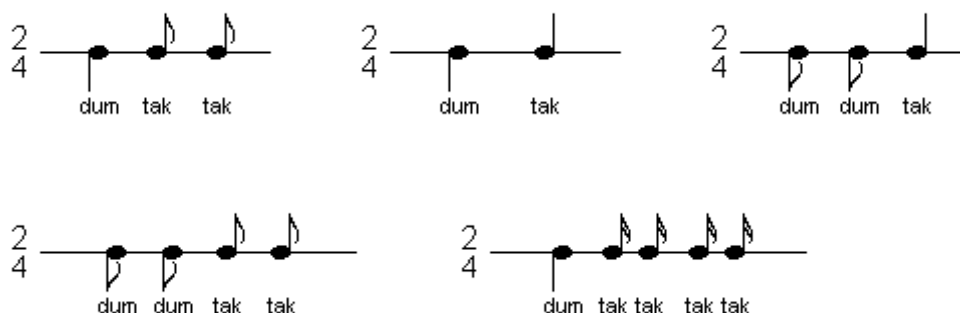
Note	Name	Note	Name
G	yekah	G	nawa
G $\sharp$ /A $\flat$	nim qarar hisar	G $\sharp$ /A $\flat$	nim hisar
G $\sharp$ /A $\flat$	qarar hisar	G $\sharp$ /A $\flat$	hisar
G $\sharp\sharp$ /A $\flat$	tik qarar hisar	G $\sharp\sharp$ /A $\flat$	tik hisar
A	ashiran	A	husayni
A $\sharp$ /B $\flat$	nim ajam ashiran	A $\sharp$ /B $\flat$	nim ajam
A $\sharp$ /B $\flat$	ajam ashiran	A $\sharp$ /B $\flat$	ajam
A $\sharp\sharp$ /B $\flat$	iraq	A $\sharp\sharp$ /B $\flat$	'awj
B	kawasht	B	mahur
B $\sharp$ /C $\flat$	tik kawasht	B $\sharp$ /C $\flat$	tik mahur
C	rast	C	kurdan
C $\sharp$ /D $\flat$	nim zirkula	C $\sharp$ /D $\flat$	nim shahnaz
C $\sharp$ /D $\flat$	zirkula	C $\sharp$ /D $\flat$	shahnaz
C $\sharp\sharp$ /D $\flat$	tik zirkula	C $\sharp\sharp$ /D $\flat$	tik shahnaz
D	dukah	D	muhayyer
D $\sharp$ /E $\flat$	nim kurd	D $\sharp$ /E $\flat$	nim sunbula
D $\sharp$ /E $\flat$	kurd	D $\sharp$ /E $\flat$	sunbula
D $\sharp\sharp$ /E $\flat$	sikah	D $\sharp\sharp$ /E $\flat$	buzurk
E	busalik	E	jawab busalik
E $\sharp$ /F $\flat$	tik busalik	E $\sharp$ /F $\flat$	tik jawab busalik
F	jahar kah	F	mahuran
F $\sharp$ /G $\flat$	nim hijaz	F $\sharp$ /G $\flat$	nim jawab hijaz
F $\sharp$ /G $\flat$	hijaz	F $\sharp$ /G $\flat$	jawab hijaz
F $\sharp\sharp$ /G $\flat$	tik hijaz	F $\sharp\sharp$ /G $\flat$	tik jawab hijaz
G	nawa	G	sahm

The Arabic Rhythms (*al-Iqa'at al-Arabia*)

The rhythmic structure of Arab music is similarly complex. Rhythmic patterns have more than 48 beats and typically include several downbeats (called *dums*) as well as upbeats (called *taks*) and silences, or rests. Each *iqa'a* has a time signature associated with it. To grasp a rhythmic mode, the listener must hear a relatively long pattern. Moreover, the performers do not simply play the pattern; they elaborate upon and ornament it. Often the pattern is recognizable by the arrangement of downbeats. The Rhythm in Arab Music illustration demonstrates a simple performance of the rhythmic mode called *sama'i thaqil*, followed by the basic-pattern.

Some common *iqa'at* are listed below: the basic form is shown first, followed by variations. Here are some traditional rhythms (mizan, iqa, vazn, darb, dawr, adwar) that are played as Arabic and Mediterranean dance rhythms or as accompaniment to Arabic Mediterranean melodies.

al-wahda as-sa'ira

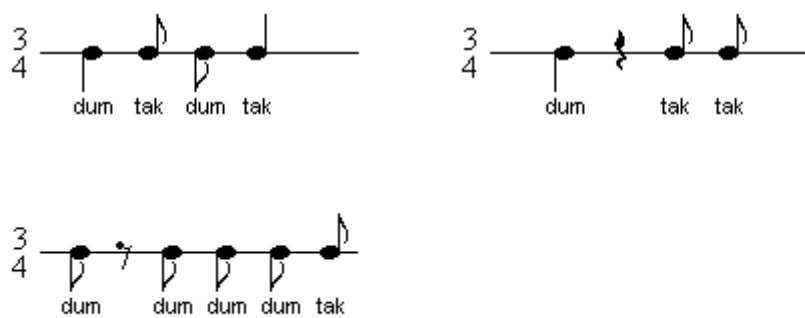


ad-darij

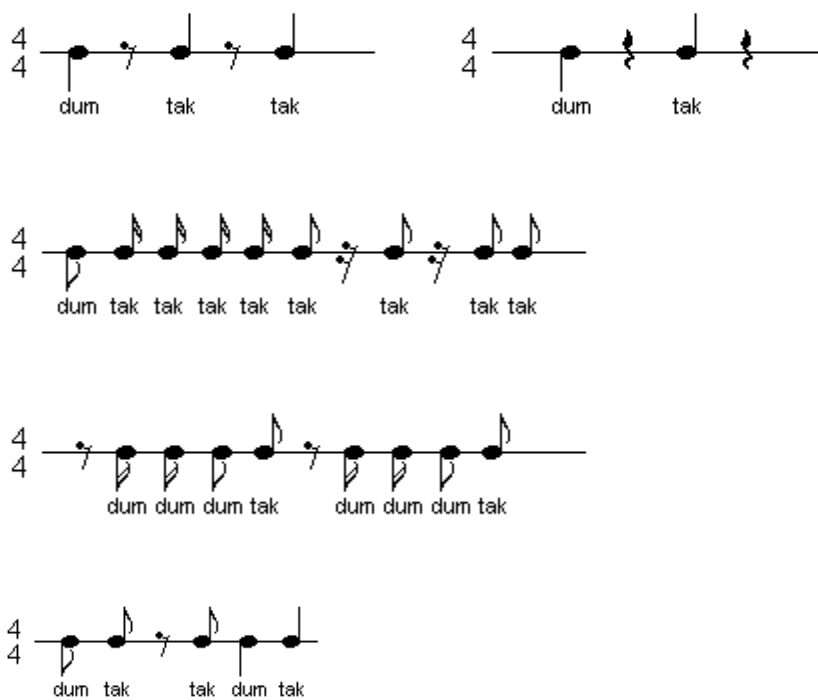


al-yuruk as-samai

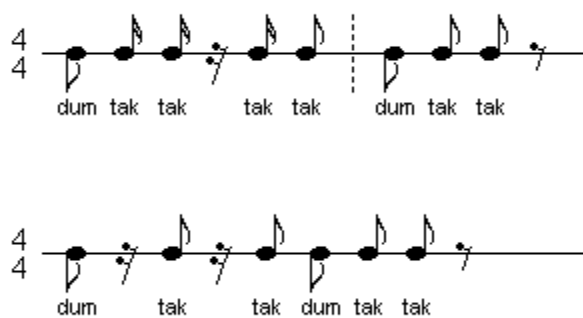




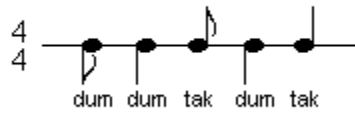
nuss al-wahda



al-wahda al-kabira

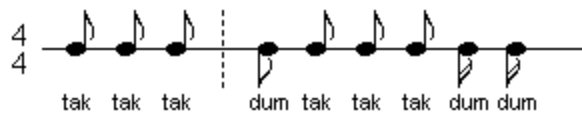
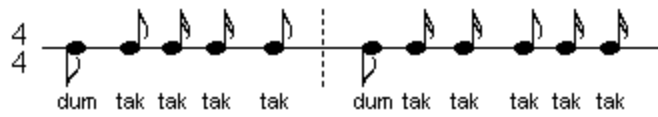
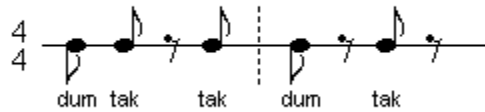


al-masmudi as-saghir



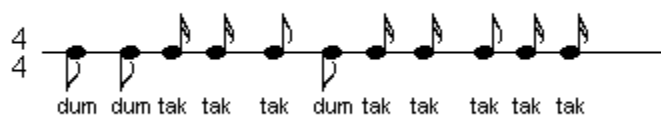
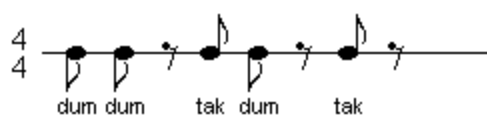
al-maqsum

A fast version of a *Baladi*, played for the fast movements of belly dance. There are variations called "*walking maqsum*" and "*marching maqsum*."

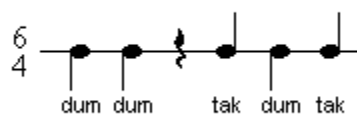


al-baladi

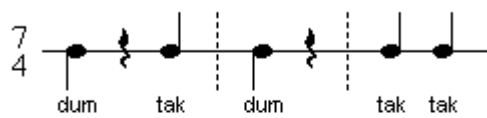
This is the standard belly dance rhythm. If you have ever heard Arabic music, you have heard *Baladi* or one of its relatives *Masmudi*, *Fallahi*, or *Maqsum*. The name *baladi* means "of the country people," but in fact the most common folk rhythm in many regions is *Fallahi*. When played slowly with a heavy beat, this rhythm is called *baladi*, but up-tempo it goes by the name *maqsum*.



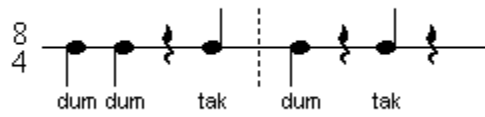
al-mudawwar al-arabi



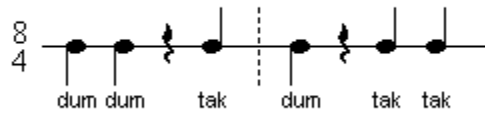
an-nawakht



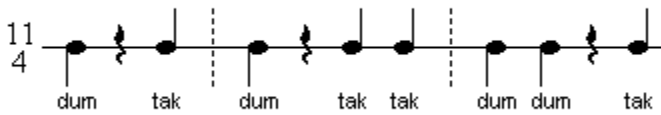
al-masmudi



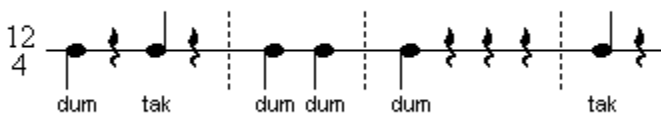
al-masmudi al-kabir



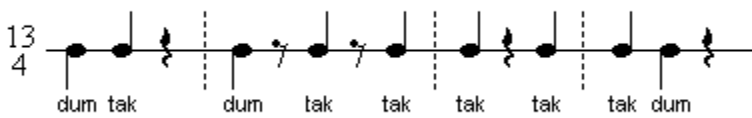
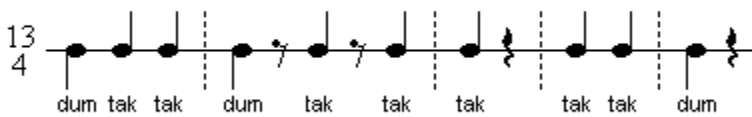
al-awis

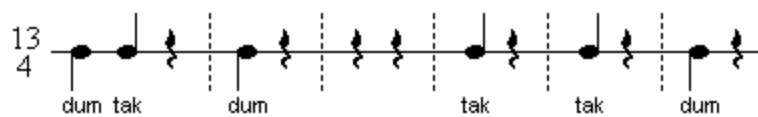
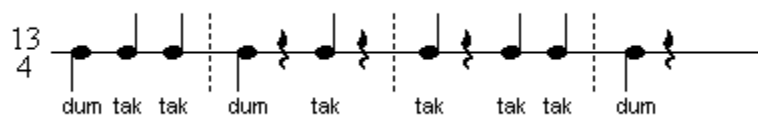
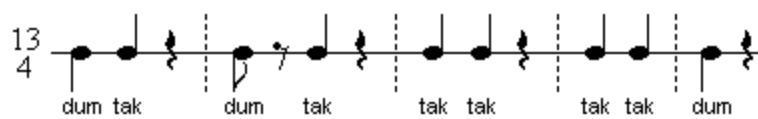


al-mudawwar



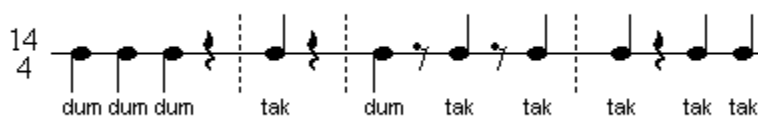
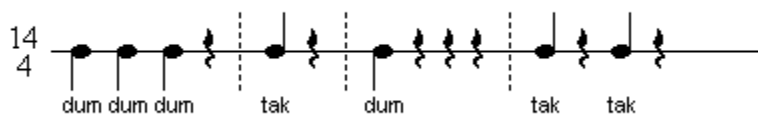
al-murabba



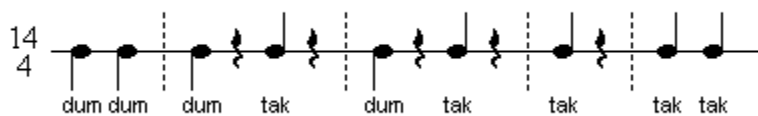


al-muhajjar

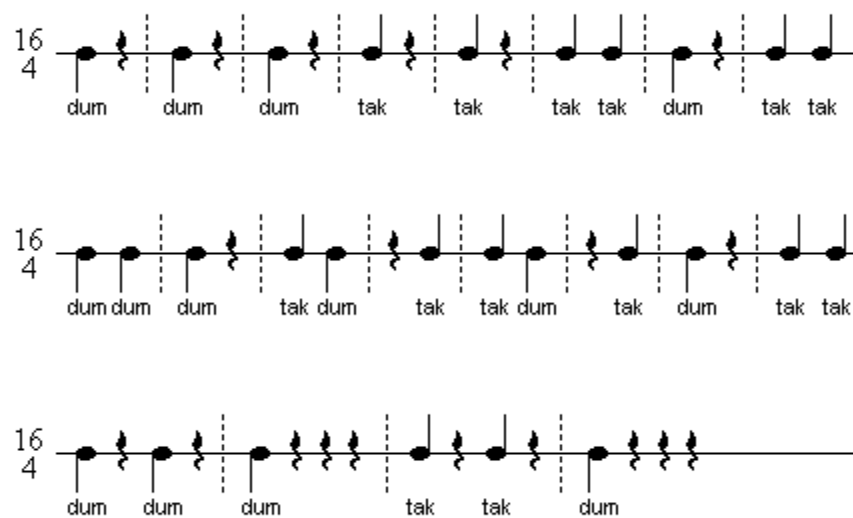
A 14/4 rhythm used to accompany *muwashshahat*.



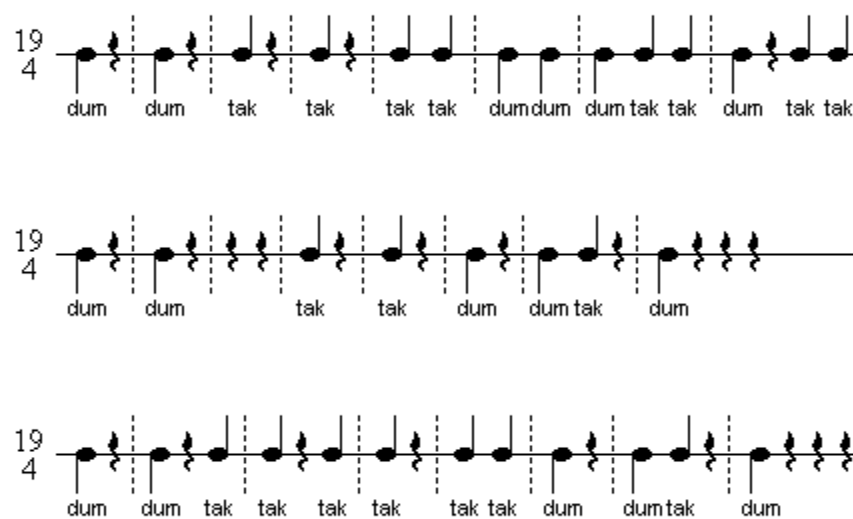
al-muhajjar al-masri



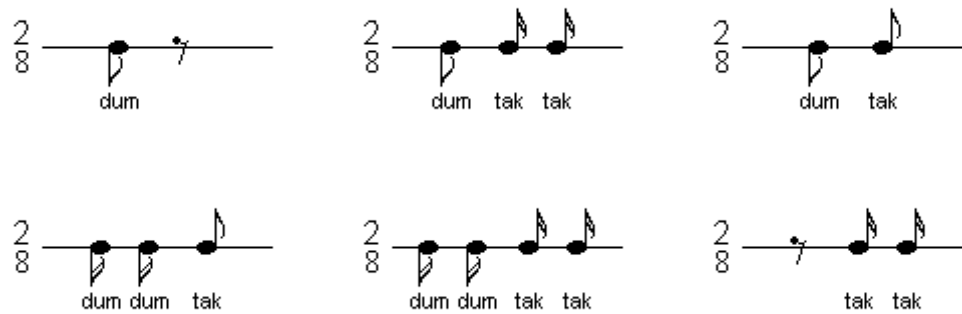
al-mukhammas al-masri



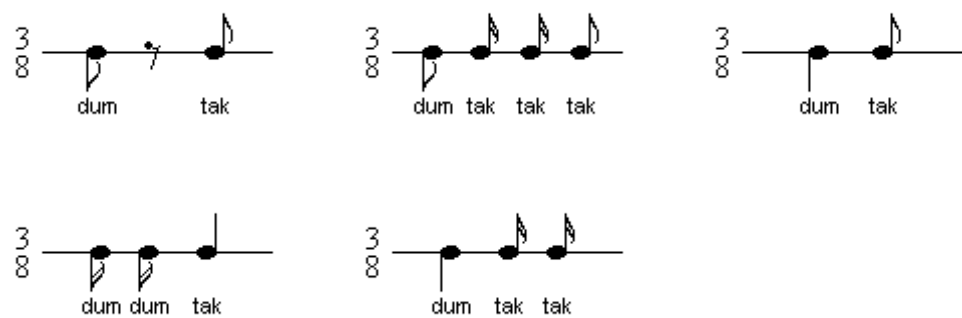
al-awfar al-masri



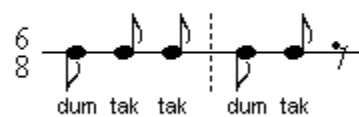
at-tair



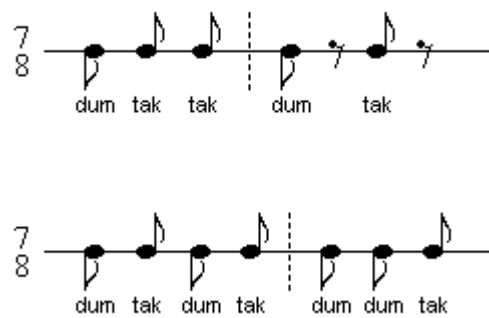
as-samai as-saraband

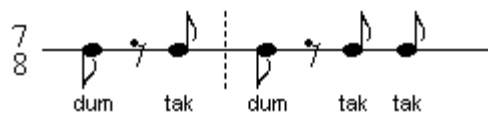
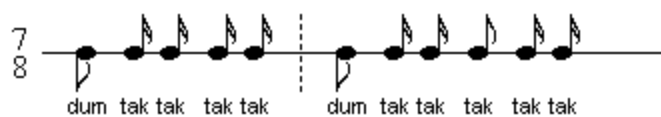


as-samai ad-darij

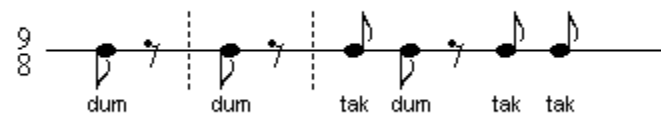
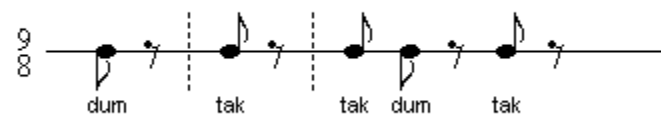
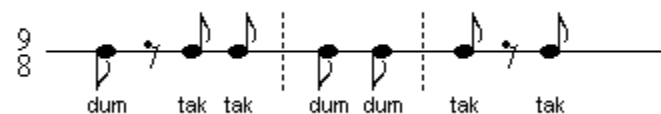


ad-dawr al-hindi



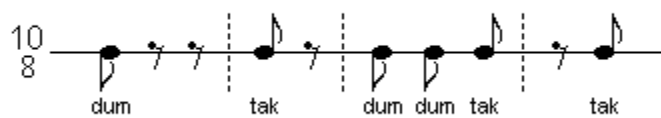
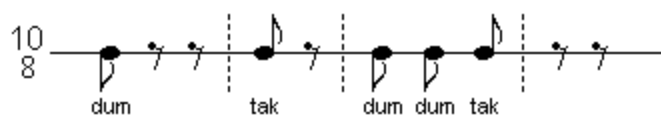


al-aqsaq

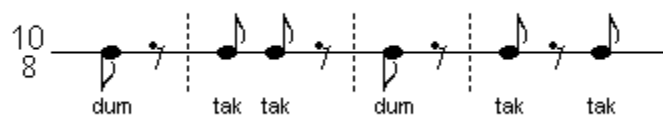


as-samai ath-thaqil

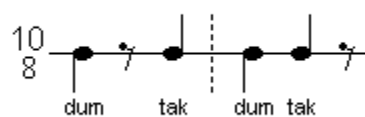
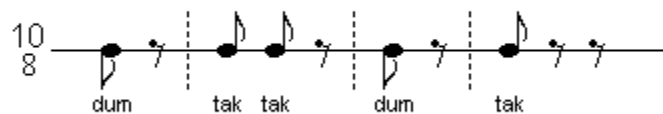
A 10/4 rhythm, this takes its name from the Turkish classical form, which it usually accompanies. This form begins in 10/4, switches to 3/4 or 6/8 in the middle, and then returns to 10/4 for a short time before it ends. Sometimes this rhythm is used to accompany pieces of music other than *sama'is*.



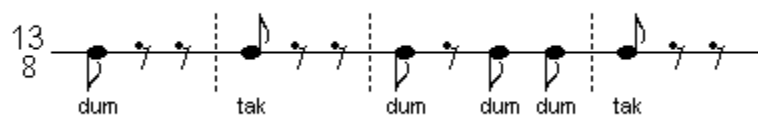
as-samai al-aqsaq



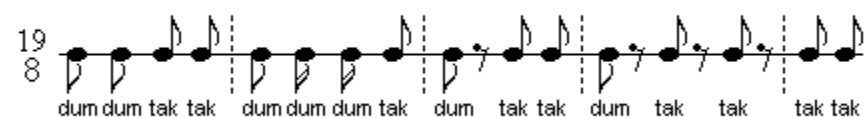
al-jurjuna



az-zarafat



al-marrasa ash-shami



The Arabic *Maqam* (*Maqamat*)

Arabic melodies draw from a vast array of models, or melodic, known as *maqamat*. Arabic books on music include as many as 52 melodic modes, of which at least 12 are commonly used. These modes feature more tones than are present in the Western musical system, including notably smaller intervals that are sometimes called microtones, or half-flats and half-sharps. Arab melodies frequently use the augmented second interval, an interval larger than those of most Western melodies. The sound of Arab music is richly melodic and offers opportunity for subtle nuance and creative variation.

We can describe the *maqam* (plural *maqamat*) as composition rules. They are definite scales, which are governed by certain rules. A *maqam* has no intrinsic (allegorical) value and is not bound to certain times of the day or year, as is the related Indian *raga*.

The *maqamat* named according to one of the following:

1. Designate an important note in the scale (*Chahargah*: fourth position, *Bayati* or *Rast*),
2. Or a city (*Esfahan*, or *Nahawand*),
3. A landscape (*Hijaz* or *Iraq*).
4. A person (*Kurd*)

Maqam principally distinguishes the eastern classical tradition from western musical practice. Based on the use of intemperate intervals (with as many as 53 microtones amplifying the western octave), a given *maqam* follows a particular scale and a set of associated musical practices. Each *maqam* joins a tetra chord, and a pentachord. Certain rules/characteristics of a *maqam* may include the entry tone (*mabda*), the final tone (*qarar*), which may or may not be the same tone as the entry tone, the leading tone, dominant and tonic as well as stressed secondary tonal centers. The range of the *maqam* may be extended above and below the octave without repeating, modulation, temperament, melody types, and cadential endings.

In Arab music notes may be raised or lowered by multiples of quartertones. These are shown in the diagram below, together with the conventional symbols used to represent them.

	Sharp	Flat
one quarter	#	b
one half	#	b
three quarters	##	bb

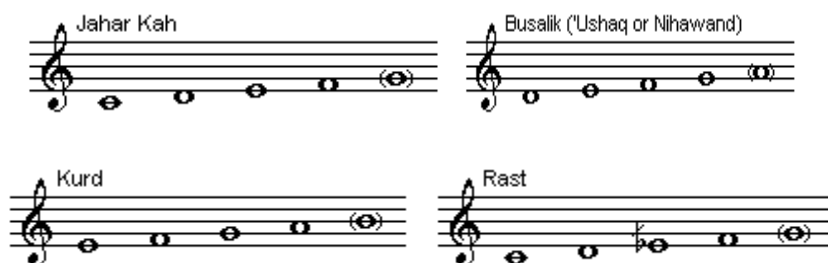
A *maqam* can normally be thought of as divided into two parts (*jins*, pl. *ajnas*); the first part is called *al-juza* and determines the nature and name of the *maqam*, and the second part is called *al-fara* and plays a secondary role. The two parts may be tetrachords or pentachords and sometimes overlap. In some cases the *maqam* is made up of three parts, in which case a trichord is used as well.

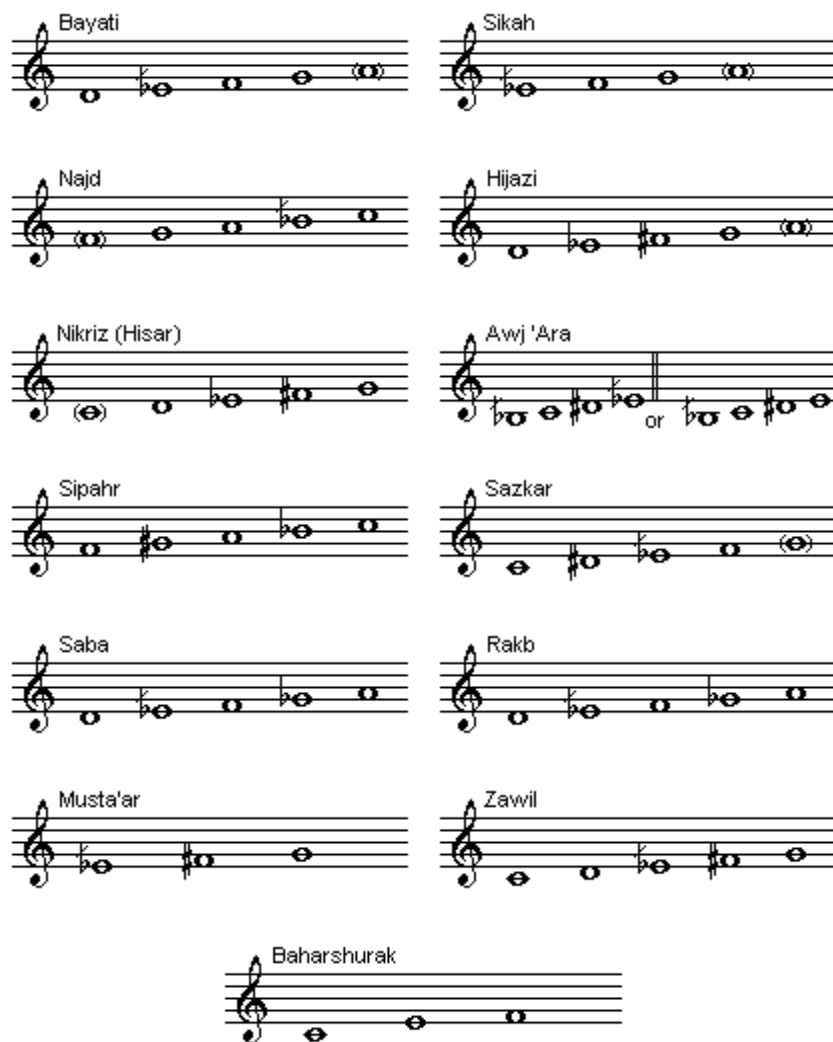
Important tones

The main tone in the scale of the *maqam* is the *qarar* or tonic/final (home key). The starting pitch of the *maqam* is called the *mabda'*, and is not necessarily the same as the *qarar*. Also important is the *ghammaz*, which is the most prominent note of the climactic part of the melody, and is often a 5th above the *qarar* (but may be a 3rd or 4th above it). The term *zahir* is used both for the note a step below the *qarar*, i.e. a leading tone, and for a cadential phrase ascending towards the *qarar*. The *zahir* may be a semitone, three-quarter tone or whole tone below the *qarar*, depending on the *maqam*. The final significant tone is the *markaz* or medial stop, on which the melody may rest during the *maqam*.

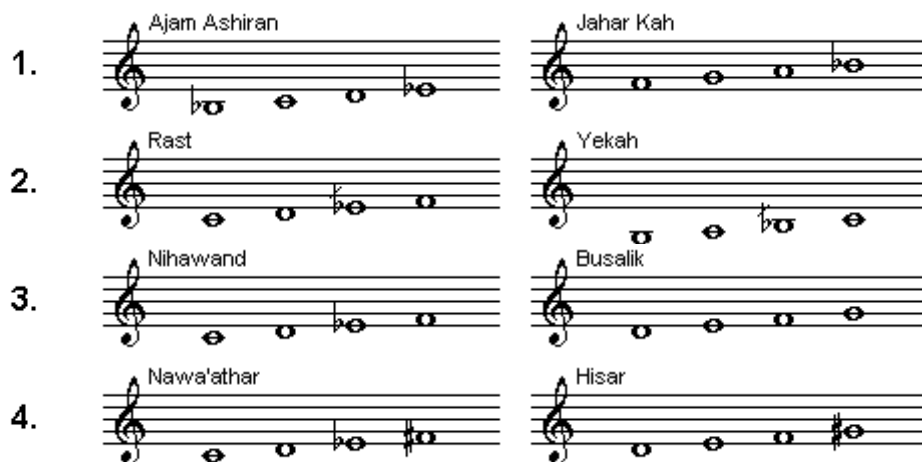
Jins (Ajnas)

All *maqamat* can be described in terms of seventeenth *jins*, illustrated in the diagram below. Each of these may be used as a trichord, tetrachord or pentachord; the brackets around a note indicate that the note is used when the *jins* functions as a pentachord, and a trichord is just the first three notes of a tetrachord.





Below, you will see a list of some common *ajnas* under eleven sections:



5. Bayati

6. Hijaz Hijaz Kar

Suzidil Shahnaz

Shadd Araban Awj 'Ara

7. Saba

8. Kurd

9. Sikah Farahnak

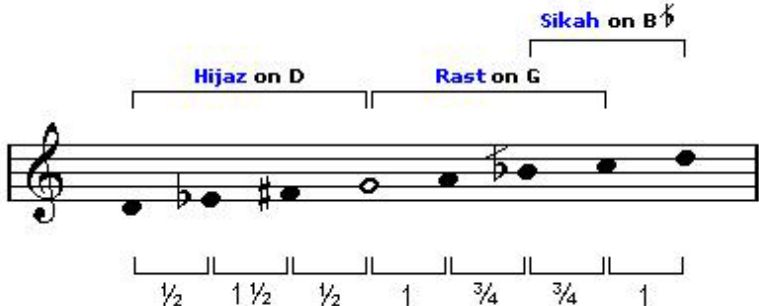
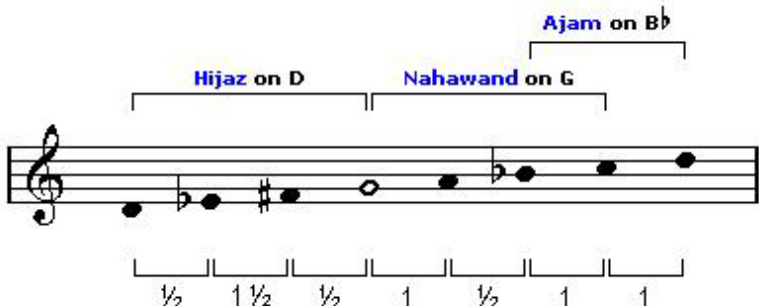
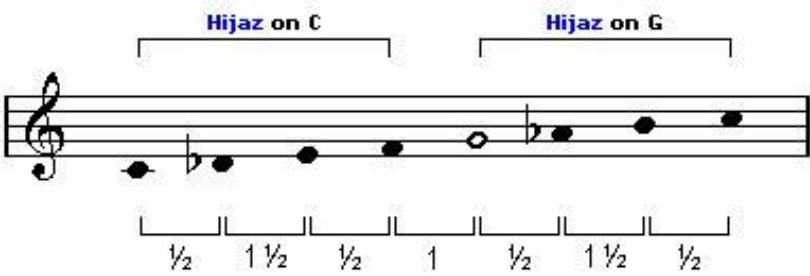
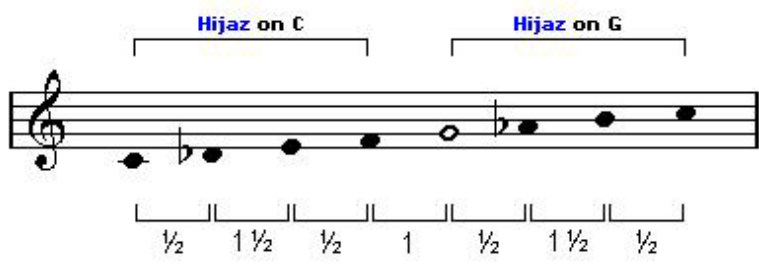
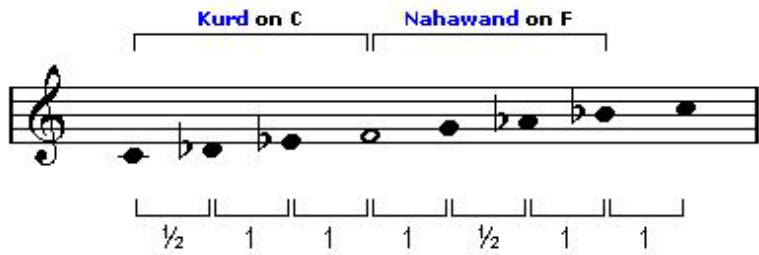
10. Iraq

11. Huzam Rahat al-Arwah

List of the most important and popular maqams in the Arabic music:

Ajam	
Athar Kurd	
Bastnaikar	
Bayati	

Bayatayn	Bayati on D Bayati on G $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 1
Bayati Shuri	Bayati on D Hijaz on G $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$ 1
Farhafza	Nahawand on G Ajam on Bb Kurd on D 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1

Hijaz	 
Hijaz Kar	
Hijaz Kar Kurd	 

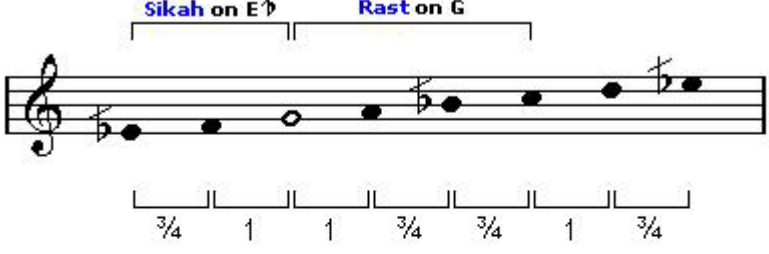
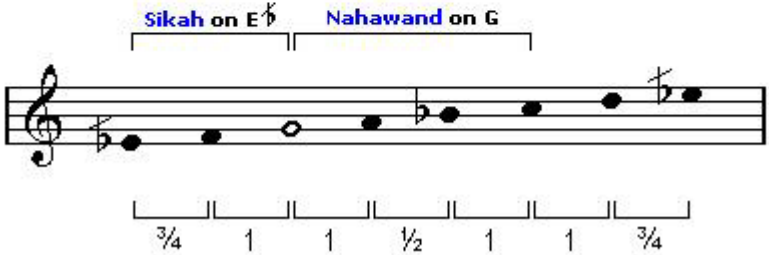
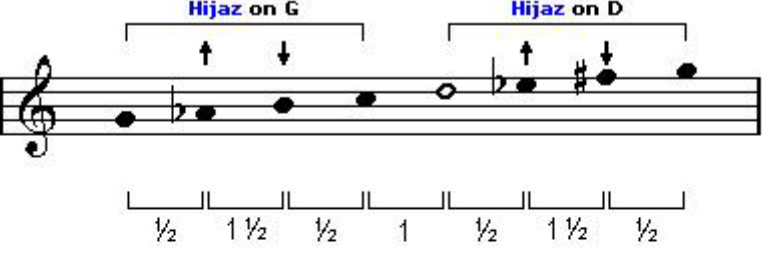
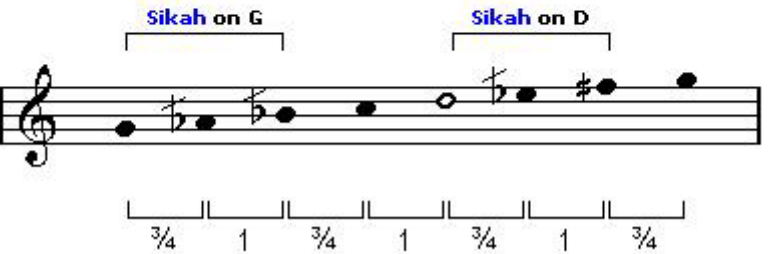
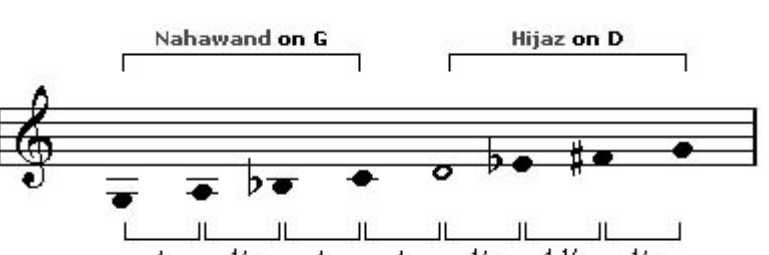
Hisar	Hijaz on E Nawa Athar on D Hijaz on A 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1/2 1 1/2 1/2
Husseini	Bayati on D Rast on G 3/4 3/4 1 1 3/4 3/4 1
Huzam	Sikah on E Hijaz on G 3/4 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1 3/4
Iraq	Sikah on B Bayati on D 3/4 1 3/4 3/4 1 1 3/4
Jaharkah	Jiharkah on F Rast on C 1 1 1/2 1 1 3/4 3/4

Kurd	Kurd on D Ajam on F Ajam on B$\flat$ Nahawand on G $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1
Mahour	Rast on C Ajam on G 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 1 1 $\frac{1}{2}$
Musta'ar	Mustaar on E$\flat$ Nahawand on G 1 $\frac{1}{4}$ $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 $\frac{3}{4}$
Nahawand	Nahawand on C Ajam on E$\flat$ Hijaz on G 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$ Nahawand on C Ajam on E$\flat$ Kurd on G 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1

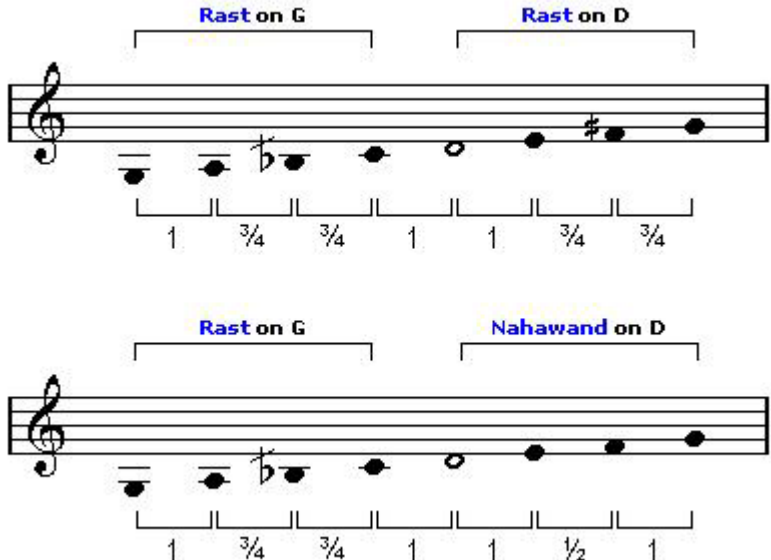
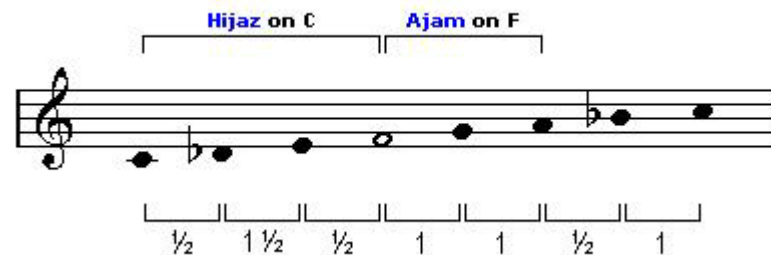
Nahawand Murass'a'	Nahawand on C Hijaz on F 1 1/2 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1
Nahfat	Bayati on D Ajam on G 3/4 3/4 1 1 1 1/2 1
Naurouz	Rast on C Sikah on E-flat Bayati on G 1 3/4 3/4 1 3/4 3/4 1
Nakriz	Hijaz on D Nawa Athar on C Hijaz on G 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1/2 1 1/2 1/2
Nawa Athar	Hijaz on D Nawa Athar on C Hijaz on G 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1/2 1 1/2 1/2

Raht El-Arawah	Sikah on B$\flat$ Hijaz on G  3/4 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1 3/4
Rast	Sikah on E$\flat$ Rast on C Rast on G  1 3/4 3/4 1 1 3/4 3/4 Sikah on E$\flat$ Rast on C Nahawand on G  1 3/4 3/4 1 1 1/2 1
Saba	Hijaz on F Saba on D Ajam on B$\flat$  3/4 3/4 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1 1 Hijaz on F Saba on D Hijaz on C  3/4 3/4 1/2 1 1/2 1/2 1 1/2 1 1/2 1/2

Saba Zamzam	Zamzama D Hijaz on F Ajam on B$\flat$
Sabr Jadid	Saba on D Hijaz on F Hijaz on A
Shadd Urban	Hijaz on G Hijaz on D
Shahnaz	Hijaz on D Hijaz on A
Shawq Afza	Ajam on B$\flat$ Hijaz on F

Sikkah	Sikkah on E $\flat$ Rast on G  Sikkah on E $\flat$ Nahawand on G 
Sikkah Baladi	Hijaz on G Hijaz on D  Sikkah on G Sikkah on D 
Sultani Yakah	Nahawand on G Hijaz on D 

Suzdoul	Hijaz on A Hijaz on E $\frac{1}{2}$ $1\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ $1\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$
Suznakk	Rast on C Sikah on E$\flat$ Hijaz on G 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ $1\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$
Taz Nuin	Sikah on E$\flat$ Saba on G Hijaz on B$\flat$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{1}{2}$ $1\frac{1}{2}$ $\frac{1}{2}$
Ushaq Massri	Busalik on D Ajam on G Bayati on A 1 $\frac{1}{2}$ 1 1 $\frac{3}{4}$ $\frac{3}{4}$ 1

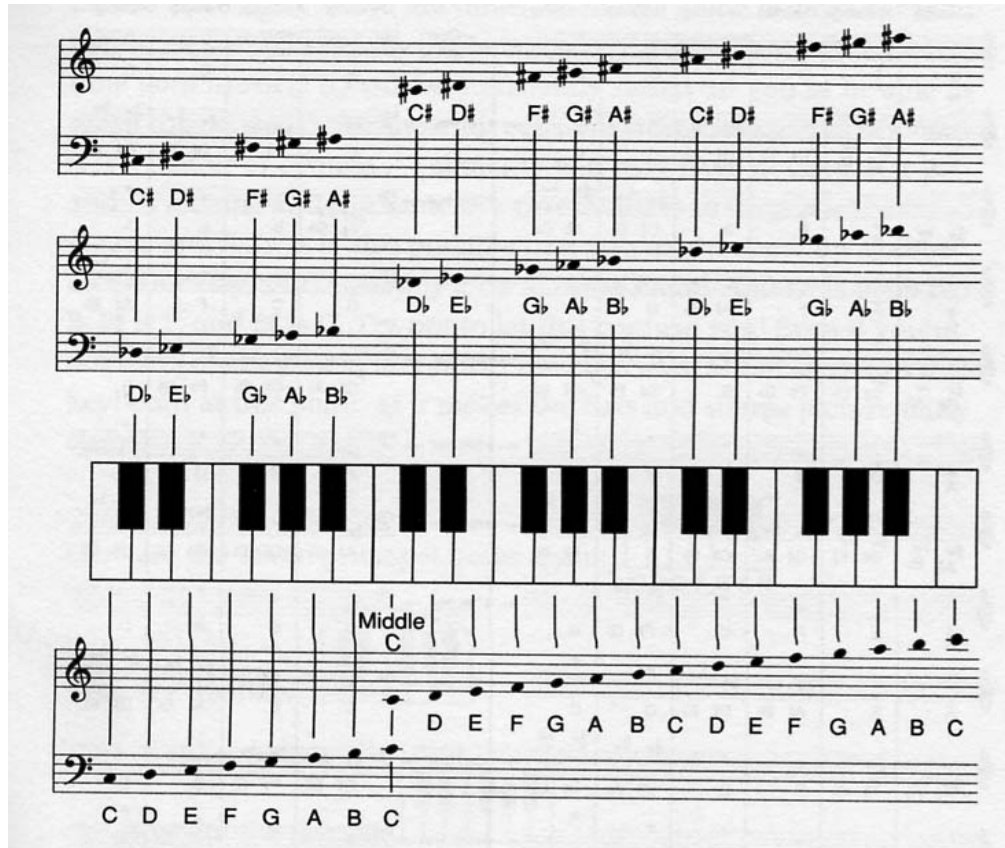
Yakkah	 The Yakkah scale is shown on a treble clef staff. It consists of two phrases. The first phrase, labeled 'Rast on G', has a duration of 1 + 3/4 + 3/4 + 1 + 1 + 3/4 + 3/4. The second phrase, labeled 'Rast on D', has a duration of 1 + 1 + 1/2 + 1. The notes are: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), C5 (quarter), D5 (half), E5 (quarter), F#5 (quarter), G5 (quarter).
Zanjaran	 The Zanjaran scale is shown on a treble clef staff. It consists of two phrases. The first phrase, labeled 'Hijaz on C', has a duration of 1/2 + 1 1/2 + 1/2 + 1. The second phrase, labeled 'Ajam on F', has a duration of 1 + 1 + 1/2 + 1. The notes are: C4 (quarter), D4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), F4 (quarter), G4 (half), A4 (quarter), Bb4 (quarter), C5 (quarter).

Exercises

In the next few pages I will present you some exercises for the *Oud* following with some of Arabic musical compositions in different format. But, before that we have to have some knowledge of the musical notations.

- Notating pitch:

In western music, seven of the twelve pitches, or tones, that fill the octave are named after the first seven letters of the alphabet: A, B, C, D, E, F, G. The C nearest to the center of the keyboard is called *middle C* (*rast in Arabic music*) as you see in the figure below.



Notes on the grand staff and their positions on the piano keyboard

A *staff* is a set of five horizontal lines. Notes are positioned either on the lines or between them, in the spaces.

- Notating rhythm and rests (silence):

A single note on the staff lasts longer or shorter depending on how it looks. It may be a white oval, or a white oval with a stem (vertical line), or black oval with one stem or more.

Silence in music can be as important as sound. In the figure bellow you will see different type of rests under each the rhythmic symbols.

Here are five symbols, arranged from longest (left) to shortest (right)					
					
NOTES	Whole	Half	Quarter	Eighth	Sixteenth
SILENCE					

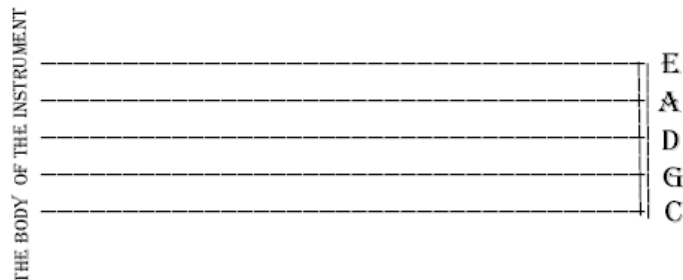
Each notes lasts half as long as the note to its left, or twice as long as the note to the right. If a quarter note lasts 1 beat, a half note gets 2 beats, and a whole gets 4 beats as you see in the figure bellow.

1 Whole Note	
= 2 Half Notes	
= 4 Quarter Notes	
= 8 Eight Notes	
=16 Sixteenth Notes	

- Notating meter:

To show the meter of a composition, composers use a *time signature* (*el-mizan el-mosiqi*). This is stated as two numbers, one over the other ($\frac{2}{4}$, $\frac{3}{4}$, $\frac{4}{4}$, $\frac{6}{8}$, etc.). A $\frac{2}{4}$ signature, for example, shows that there are two beats.

The name of the *Oud* strings:

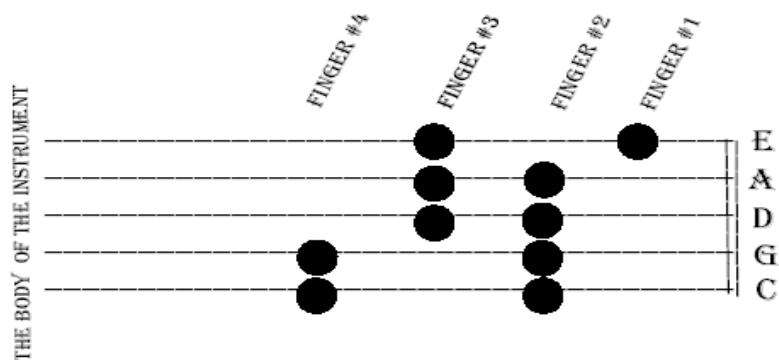


(Exercises 1-2 will help you to play open strings and using the *Risha*. Try to repeat each exercise as many time as you can).

Exercise 1: you will learn how to use the *risha*, open strings, quarter notes and quarter rests, and the time signature



The positions of the 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th fingers on the *Oud*:



Exercise 2: you will learn the eighth notes using the open strings.



(Exercises 3-7 will help you to play the Natural notes in the first position of the Oud. Try to repeat each exercise as many times as you can, slowly but surely).

Exercise 3: string E (E-open string, F-1st finger, and G 2nd finger).



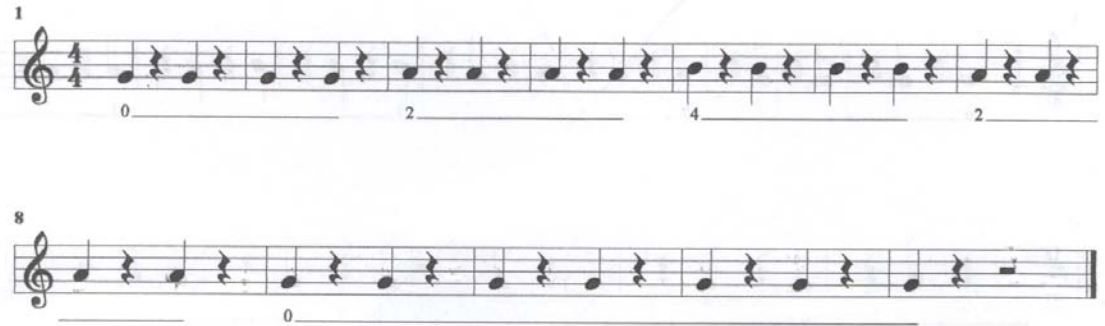
Exercise 4: string A (A-open finger, B-2nd finger, and C- 3rd finger).



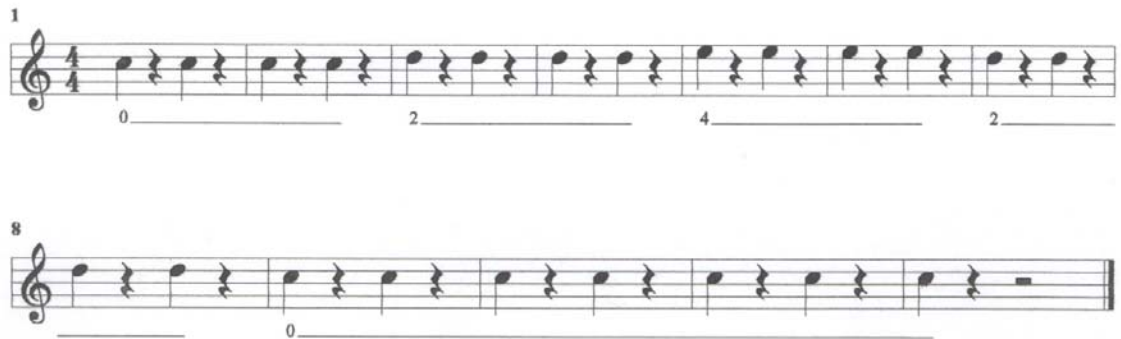
Exercise 5: string D (D-open finger, E-2nd finger, and F-3rd finger).



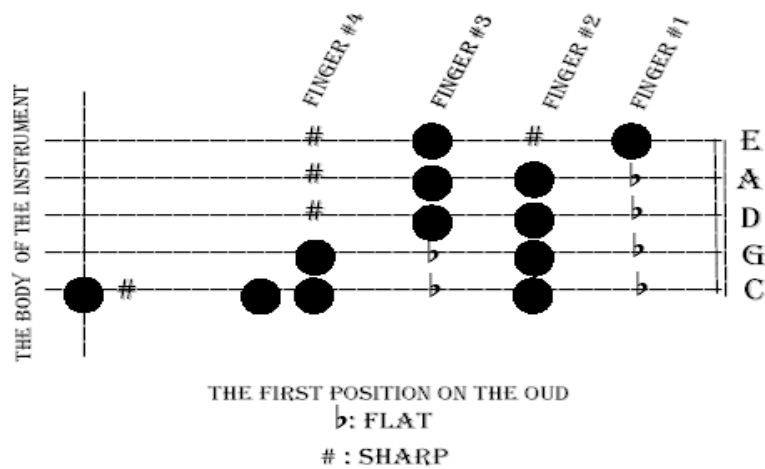
Exercise 6: string G (G-open finger, A-2nd finger, and B-4th finger).



Exercise 7: string C (C-open finger, D-2nd finger, and E-4th finger).



This figure of the 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th fingers on the *Oud* using *flat* notes and *sharp* notes.



(Exercises 8-12 will help you to play the flat and sharp notes. Try to repeat each exercise as many times as you can, slowly but surely).

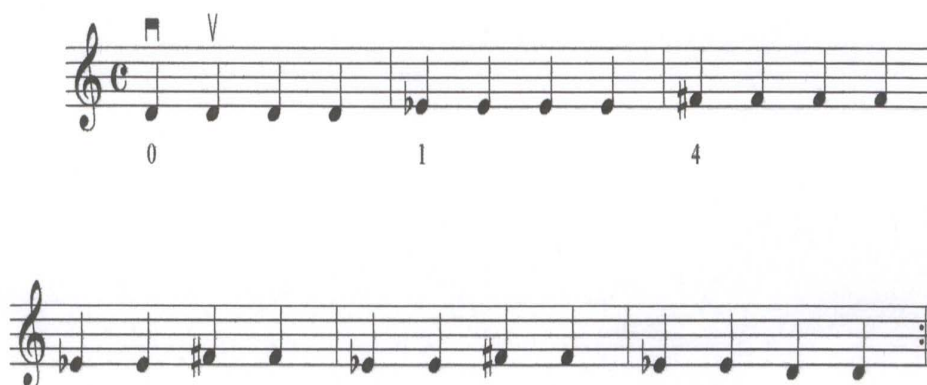
Exercise 8: string E (E-open string, F *sharp*-2nd finger, and G *sharp*-4th finger).



Exercise 9: string A (A-open finger, B *flat*-1st finger, and C *sharp*-4th finger).



Exercise 10: string D (D-open finger, E *flat*-1st finger, and F *sharp*-4th finger).



Exercise 11: string G (G-open finger, A *flat*-1st finger, and B *flat*-3rd finger).



Exercise 12: string C (C-open finger, D *flat*-1st finger, and E *flat*-3rd finger).



Melody # 1 in Cm (Nahawand-in Arabic music)



Melody # 2 in F (Jaharkah)



Melody # 3 in F (Jaharkah)



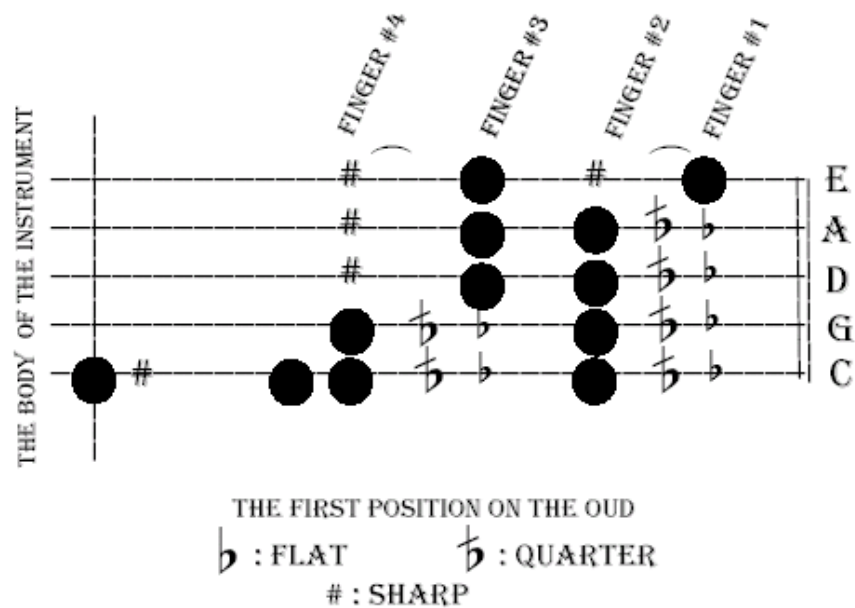
Melody # 4 in Hijaz



Melody # 5 in Hijaz



This figure of the 1st, 2nd, 3rd, and 4th fingers on the *Oud* using flat, sharp and quarter (flat) notes.



As you notes; you will use the first finger for the flat and the quarter- flat- notes.
Also, you will use the 4th finger as a natural and quarter-flat-notes.

Melody # 6 in Bayati

Allegro Moderato: 110

The musical score for Melody # 6 in Bayati is written in G major (one sharp) and 2/4 time. It consists of four staves. The first staff has a tempo marking of 'Allegro Moderato: 110'. The notes are: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). Fingerings are: 2 3 0 2, 2 0, 0 2 3. The second staff has notes: D4 (half), C#4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). Fingerings are: 0 4 0 2 0 3 3 0 2 3 2 0. The third staff has notes: D4 (half), C#4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). Fingerings are: 2 1 0. The fourth staff has a single note: D4 (half). The word 'Fine' is written at the end of the third staff.

Melody # 7 in Rast

Moderato: 94

The musical score for Melody # 7 in Rast is written in G major (one sharp) and 2/4 time. It consists of four staves. The first staff has a tempo marking of 'Moderato: 94'. The notes are: G4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). Fingerings are: 0 0 1 2 3 2 4. The second staff has notes: D4 (half), C#4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). Fingerings are: 1 2. The third staff has notes: D4 (half), C#4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). The fourth staff has notes: D4 (half), C#4 (quarter), B4 (quarter), A4 (quarter), G4 (quarter), F#4 (quarter), E4 (quarter), D4 (half). The word 'taqsim...' is written at the end of the fourth staff.

Melody # 8 in Sika

M. Allegro: 115

1 3 0 0 0 4

4 1

Fine

Melody # 9 in Hijaz D (Dokah)

Moderato: 95

2 0 4 0 4 2 0 4 0 2 0

0 3 2 0 4 3 0

4 1 0 2 0 0 4

0 3 1 1 0 1 4 1 0

Melody # 10 in Hijaz Kar

Andantino: 58

1 0 4 1 0 4 1 0 3 0 1 4 0

0 1. 3 1 4 3

3 4 3 1 4 3 2 3

Melody # 11: Dolab Hijaz Kar

Dolab Hijaz Kar

Moderato: 100

S. S. Abddon

0 4 0 1 4

4 1 0 3 0 1

2 3 0 1 2 3 4 4

1 2

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Longa Yorgo

